# WHO IS ALLOWED TO SAY IT

WRITING

EXOD 3–4

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

Dominion governs address: which name, which title, in whose presence, on whose authority. Exodus 3 is the founding text for that whole apparatus, and also for its failure — the name is given to a fugitive shepherd, not to an institution.

1 · THE SANCTUM'S AUTHORIZED FORMS OF ADDRESS — AND WHAT IS FORBIDDEN OUTSIDE THE TEMPLE

2 · A CHARACTER WHO PRAYS USING A NAME THEY WERE NOT GIVEN PERMISSION TO USE

3 · FIVE OBJECTIONS — WRITE THE REFUSALS OF SOMEONE BEING SENT, AND WHAT ANSWERS EACH

4 · A SCENE THAT IS NEVER EXPLAINED — WRITE ONE AND LEAVE IT UNEXPLAINED

EXOD 7–12

EXOD 7.3

EXOD 8 .15, 32

EXOD 9 .20–21

EXOD 10 .7

PROPP, EXODUS 1–18

FRETHEIM, EXODUS

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns mass death, including the death of children, presented in the text as divine action. It does not quote the imagery at length. You may work it later, or not at all, and the dossier still functions.

# A CONTEST, NOT A TANTRUM

The signs are staged as a public contest over who governs: the Nile, the livestock, the light, the firstborn — each a pillar of Egyptian order and of Pharaoh's claim to be its guarantor. The text says twice that the point is to be known, by Egypt and by Israel. **[C]** Reading the sequence as a systematic attack on a state's legitimacy rather than a list of disasters is a common interpretation and a strong one, not something the book states outright. **[P]**

| SIGN | WHAT IT STRIKES | WHO HARDENS |
|---|---|---|
| Blood · 7 | The Nile — the water supply and the state's central image of life. Court specialists reproduce it. | Pharaoh's heart is strong |
| Frogs, gnats, flies · 8 | Habitability. The specialists fail at the third, and say so to the king. | He hardens himself |
| Livestock, boils · 9 | Capital and bodies — the economy first, then the people who run it. | Mixed reports |
| Hail · 9 | The harvest, with a warning issued first — and some officials act on the warning and shelter their workers. | He admits fault, then reverses |
| Locusts, darkness · 10 | Food and daylight. His own courtiers ask him to concede; negotiations break down over who may leave. | The LORD hardens him |
| The firstborn · 11–12 | Succession itself, from the throne to the prison, and the livestock with it. The text records a great cry in Egypt. | Release, then pursuit |

THE HARDENING PROBLEM — DO NOT RESOLVE IT ON THE PAGE

The text distributes the hardening: sometimes Pharaoh hardens his own heart, sometimes his heart is simply strong, and sometimes God hardens it. The Hebrew uses more than one verb, and the pattern shifts as the cycle proceeds. Whether this is one theology, two sources joined, or a deliberate escalation is argued in the commentaries and not settled here. Any sermon that has never noticed the problem is not reading the book. **[R]**

WHO PAYS FOR A RULER'S REFUSAL IN DOMINION — AND WHO IS TOLD IT WAS NECESSARY

# PASSOVER AND MEMORY

EXOD 12 .1–28

EXOD 12 .26–27

EXOD 12 .38, 48–49

EXOD 12 .35–36

EXOD 13 .1–16

MEYERS, EXODUS

TKC: CELESTE

The narrative stops, at its most urgent point, to install a liturgy — with a calendar, a household unit, portion rules for a household too small for a whole animal, dress instructions, and a script for answering a child's question years later. Liberation is legislated as an annual practice before it has happened. **[C]**

### THE HOUSEHOLD IS THE UNIT

Not the temple, not the city, not the priesthood — there is no priesthood yet. A family, a doorway, and a shared meal. The founding rite of the people is performed at home, by whoever is at home. **[C]**

### THE CHILD'S QUESTION

The instruction assumes children will ask what the practice means, and supplies the answer as a first-person account: this is what was done for us. Memory is transmitted as testimony inside a family, which is exactly the transmission an empire cannot license. **[C]**

### WHO ELSE LEFT

The text notes a mixed company going up with them, and the Passover rules then address the resident foreigner: they may keep it under a stated condition. The founding ritual has an inclusion clause and a boundary in the same paragraph. **[C]**

### THE UNPAID WAGES

Departing Israelites ask for and receive silver, gold, and clothing from Egyptian neighbors. Translations differ on whether the verb means to ask, to borrow, or to plunder, and the passage has been read both as reparation for unpaid labor and as despoiling. Name the reading you are using. **[R]**

### THE FIRSTBORN CLAUSE

Immediately after the deliverance, every firstborn is declared to belong to God, with animals redeemed and sons redeemed. A claim on the next generation is written into the liberation itself, and later texts spend considerable energy managing it. **[C]**

THE RITE MY FAMILY KEEPS THAT NO INSTITUTION ISSUED — AND WHAT IT TRANSMITS

EXOD 14

EXOD 15 .1–18

EXOD 15 .20–21

NUM 12 (COMPARE)

TRIBLE, "BRINGING MIRIAM OUT"

CROSS, CANAANITE MYTH & HEBREW EPIC

# TWO TELLINGS OF ONE CROSSING

Chapter 14 narrates the crossing in prose; chapter 15 sings it. The two do not describe the mechanics the same way, and the poem is widely regarded as very old material. Reading them together is a lesson in how an event becomes a liturgy, and how the liturgy then becomes the memory. **[R]**

| | THE PROSE · CH. 14 | THE POEM · CH. 15 |
|---|---|---|
| MECHANISM | A strong east wind through the night, waters divided, dry ground, walls of water. | A blast of breath, the sea piling up, the enemy sinking like a stone. Storm imagery, not a corridor. |
| HUMAN ROLE | Moses stretches out his hand; the people are told to be still, and then to move. | No human agency in the act at all. The victory is entirely God's. |
| THE ENEMY | Chariots, officers, horsemen — a named military force pursuing escapees. | A boasting voice quoted and then drowned; the nations who hear of it are named and afraid. |
| ENDS WITH | Bodies on the shore, and the people trusting Moses. | A sanctuary and a throne — the poem leaps to a mountain and a reign. |
| WHO SINGS | — | Moses and the people; then Miriam, called a prophet, with a hand-drum, leading the women in the same opening line. **[C]** |

### MIRIAM, PROPHET AND SONG-LEADER

This is her introduction by title, and it is the first time a woman in the Torah is called a prophet. She leads a musical company; the verse she sings is the poem's own opening. Some scholars have argued that the whole song was originally hers, on the strength of that placement — a proposal worth knowing and not a settled result. **[R]** Hold this page next to the Focused Study on Numbers 12, where the same woman is punished for speaking. **[P]**

THE VICTORY SONG DOMINION SINGS — AND WHO IS ALLOWED TO LEAD IT

# THE WEEK AFTER THE SEA

WRITING

EXOD 15 .22–27

EXOD 16

EXOD 18 .13–26

TKC: DOM

Three days after the song they have no water, and by chapter 16 they are saying they were better off fed in Egypt. Freedom arrives with a supply problem, an administration problem, and a memory problem. That is the part every liberation story leaves out.

1 · THE FIRST SHORTAGE AFTER A LIBERATION IN MY WORLD — AND WHO IS BLAMED FOR IT

2 · A CHARACTER WHO SAYS OUT LOUD THAT THE OLD ARRANGEMENT FED THEM BETTER

3 · THE MANNA RULE — A RATION NOBODY CAN HOARD. WHAT WOULD DOMINION DO TO IT?

4 · JETHRO'S ADVICE — DELEGATED JUDGES. WRITE THE MOMENT A MOVEMENT GETS A BUREAUCRACY

EXOD 19

EXOD 20 .1–17

DEUT 5 (COMPARE)

EXOD 20 .18–21

EXOD 24 .3–8

MCCARTHY, TREATY AND COVENANT

CHILDS, EXODUS

# A TREATY, A MOUNTAIN, A BOUNDARY

The covenant at Sinai is staged with the forms of an ancient treaty: a historical preamble naming what the sovereign has already done, stipulations, a public reading, an assent, and a ratification rite with blood. The scene also installs access control — a boundary at the foot of the mountain, and rules about who may cross it. **[C]**

### THE PREAMBLE IS THE ARGUMENT

The commandments open by naming the speaker as the one who brought them out of the house of slavery. Obligation is grounded in a completed act of liberation, not in creation or in raw power. Any use of the Ten that drops that clause has changed what kind of document it is. **[P]**

### TWO NUMBERINGS, ONE TEXT

Jewish, Catholic and Lutheran, and Reformed traditions divide the same words into ten differently — which clause counts as the first, and whether coveting is one command or two. The Deuteronomy version also differs from this one, notably in the reason given for the sabbath. Print which numbering you are using. **[R]**

### WHO THE SABBATH COMMAND ADDRESSES

It names the household head, the children, the enslaved man and woman, the livestock, and the resident foreigner. It is a labor law addressed to the person with the power to compel work, and its subject is everyone that person can compel. **[C]**

### THE LAST COMMAND LISTS PROPERTY

House, wife, enslaved persons, ox, donkey. The wife appears inside an inventory of a neighbor's holdings. That the list reflects a household economy in which she is counted among assets is plain on the page; what a reader should do with it is the argument. **[P]**

### THE PEOPLE ASK FOR A MEDIATOR

Frightened by the thunder, they ask Moses to speak with God on their behalf. The office of the intermediary is created by popular request, and every priesthood afterward has that verse available. **[C]**

DOMINION'S FOUNDING DOCUMENT — WHAT DOES ITS PREAMBLE CLAIM TO HAVE DONE FOR YOU?

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns slavery, debt bondage, and the legal status of enslaved women and children in the covenant code. It reports what the text legislates without endorsing it.

# THE FIRST LAWS AFTER THE TEN

Chapters 21–23 are case law in the ordinary ancient form: if this, then that. What is striking is the order. Immediately after the covenant is ratified, the first subject legislated is slavery — by a people who were just freed. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| DEBT SLAVERY | A Hebrew man sold for debt serves six years and goes free in the seventh, without payment. If he came in married, his wife leaves with him; if the master gave him a wife, she and the children remain, and he may choose permanent servitude to stay with them. Freedom is granted to him and withheld from her. **[C]** |
| THE DAUGHTER SOLD | A separate rule governs a daughter sold by her father, with obligations of food, clothing, and marital rights, and a release provision if those are not met. The protections are real and the transaction is still a sale. Both facts belong on the page. **[C]** |
| INJURY AND STATUS | Penalties vary by the status of the injured person: a free man, a pregnant woman, an enslaved person, an ox. Comparing the schedules shows exactly what a life is worth in the system the law assumes. **[C]** |
| MONEY LAW | No interest charged to the poor of your own people; a cloak taken as a pledge returned before nightfall, because it is what they sleep in. Credit is regulated at the point where it takes someone's bedding. **[C]** |
| THE FOREIGNER | Do not wrong the resident foreigner, twice, and both times the stated reason is experiential: you know what it is to be one. Memory is used as legal grounding. **[C]** |
| COURTS | Do not follow a crowd to pervert justice; do not favor the poor in a lawsuit either; take no bribe; do not deny justice to your poor. Impartiality is commanded in both directions, which is more interesting than either slogan built on it. **[C]** |
| THE SEVENTH YEAR | Land rests in the seventh year and what grows is left for the poor and the wild animals. Rest is legislated for soil, animals, and workers in the same body of law. **[C]** |

HOW TO READ IT WITHOUT LYING IN EITHER DIRECTION

This code is neither an abolition document nor an endorsement of chattel slavery as later practiced. It regulates a debt-bondage system common to its world, imposes limits some neighboring collections do not, and leaves enslaved women with markedly fewer exits than men. Say all three. Do not print "the Bible abolished slavery" and do not print "the Bible authorized the plantation." **[P]**

WHICH OF THESE CLAUSES DOMINION KEEPS, AND WHICH IT HAS QUIETLY REPEALED

EXOD 21 .1–11

EXOD 21 .20–27

EXOD 22 .21–27

EXOD 23 .1–12

LAWS OF HAMMURABI (ROTH)

WRIGHT, INVENTING GOD'S LAW

TKC: DOM · MEN

EXOD 32 .1–6

EXOD 32 .21–24

EXOD 32 .25–29

EXOD 32 .11–14, 32

EXOD 33 .18–23

EXOD 34 .6–7

CHILDS, EXODUS

# FORTY DAYS UNSUPERVISED

While the sanctuary instructions are being given on the mountain, the people below ask the acting authority for a god they can see, and Aaron makes one out of their jewelry and declares a festival to the LORD. The crisis is not simple idol worship — it is a leadership vacuum, an authorized official improvising, and a rite performed in the right name with the wrong object. **[C]**

### AARON IS NOT PUNISHED

He collects the gold, makes the image, builds the altar, announces the feast, and then tells Moses the calf came out of the fire on its own. He remains high priest. Hold that next to who does get killed in the same chapter. **[C]**

### THE PURGE

Moses calls for those on his side, the Levites answer, and they are ordered through the camp with swords; the text reports about three thousand dead and then says the Levites were thereby ordained. A priesthood is established by an internal massacre, and the book says so plainly. This companion does not soften it and does not print approval of it. **[C]**

### MOSES ARGUES WITH GOD, TWICE

First he talks God out of destroying the people, using reputation and the ancestral promise as arguments. Then he offers to be struck out of the book himself instead. Intercession here is legal advocacy, and the text presents God as persuadable. **[C]**

### THE REQUEST TO SEE

He asks to see the glory and is refused the face and granted the back, from a cleft in the rock. What he is given instead is a spoken self-description — merciful, slow to anger, forgiving, and not clearing the guilty — which the rest of the Hebrew Bible quotes and argues with repeatedly. **[C]**

### THE SECOND SET OF TABLETS

The covenant is rewritten after being broken, and the sanctuary is then built with materials brought voluntarily, in quantities that have to be stopped. The book ends with a structure, a cloud, and a schedule — institution as the last word. **[C]**

WHO IN MY WORLD SURVIVES THE THING THEY BUILT, AND WHO DIES FOR ATTENDING IT

# ONE PASSAGE, WORKED PROPERLY

Choose one passage from Exodus and run the whole method on it across this spread. Suggested, if you want one chosen: 21:2–11, the slave laws, or 1:15–21, the midwives. Write the passage reference and the translation you are using at the top, then work down.

PASSAGE

TRANSLATION USED

1 · WHAT IT SAYS — SUMMARIZE WITHOUT INTERPRETING. NO CONCLUSIONS YET.

2 · WHO IS SPEAKING, TO WHOM, IN WHAT SITUATION

3 · WHERE TWO TRANSLATIONS DIFFER, AND WHAT TURNS ON THE DIFFERENCE



SEE PART I METHOD PAGES

METHOD

PASSAGE PRACTICE

TKC: DOM · CT

4 · HOW THIS PASSAGE HAS BEEN USED AGAINST SOMEONE — NAME THE USE, NOT ONLY THE ABUSE

5 · WHAT IT REFUSES TO SETTLE — THE QUESTION THE TEXT LEAVES OPEN

6 · WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH IT — WHICH CLAUSE THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES

7 · WHAT I AM TAKING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHICH CHAPTER

STATUS OF WHAT I JUST WROTE

Anything discovered on these two pages begins as **Possible**. Promote it to Canon only after deciding it belongs in the manuscript and recording where it affects the existing files.

# THE MOST BORROWED BOOK

Exodus is quoted by the enslaved and by the enslavers, by prophets, by empires, by movements, and by settlers. The reception history is not an appendix to the book; for a novelist writing an empire with a scripture, it is the primary material. Every line below is reception, marked as such. **[R]**

| | |
|---|---|
| INSIDE THE BIBLE | The prophets use the deliverance as a standard to judge Israel by; the return from exile is described in exodus language; the Gospels place Jesus in a wilderness and on a mountain, and Paul reads the crossing typologically. Reuse begins in the canon itself. **[C]** |
| THE SPIRITUALS | Enslaved Black Americans made Exodus the central text of a sung theology — Pharaoh, the river, the promised land — often with a double meaning: a coded present tense inside a biblical past. This is the single most important reception stream for this companion. **[R]** |
| SLAVEHOLDER USE | The same book was preached to the enslaved with the deliverance removed and the obedience clauses kept, and the covenant code's slave laws were cited as authorization. The text did not prevent this; the selection did it. **[R]** |
| LIBERATION READINGS | Twentieth-century Black and Latin American theologians made the exodus the interpretive center of scripture: God is disclosed as one who takes sides. Cone is the reference point for the Black theological line. **[R]** |
| THE CANAANITE PROBLEM | Native American and Palestinian readers have pointed out that the story does not end at the sea — it ends in someone else's land, and settler movements have used it that way. Warrior's essay is the standard entry point. A companion that celebrates the exodus without naming this has not finished reading. **[R]** |
| CIVIL RIGHTS ERA | Mid-century American movement preaching returned to Pharaoh, the wilderness, and the mountaintop as the working vocabulary of a political campaign. The imagery your characters would have inherited is this one. **[R]** |

WHICH RECEPTION STREAM MY CHARACTERS WERE RAISED INSIDE — AND WHO EDITED IT FOR THEM

ISA 43 .16–21

1 COR 10 .1–5

CONE, BLACK THEOLOGY OF LIBERATION

WARRIOR, "CANAANITES, COWBOYS, AND INDIANS"

TKC: DOM · TL

EXOD 20.2

EXOD 20 .8–11

EXOD 22 .25–27

TKC: DOM

TKC: SANCTUM · HULDAH

# A DELIVERANCE ALREADY SPENT

An empire cannot suppress this book — it is too well known. So it dates it. The deliverance is taught as accomplished, in the founding, by the Empire itself; what remains for the present is the obedience section. Everything below is a TKC construction to be tested against the manuscript, not a claim about scripture. **[P]**

| WHAT THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES | WHAT IT LEAVES IN THE CLOSED CATECHISM |
|---|---|
| The sea — deliverance as a founding event, already granted. | Chapter 1 — that the resistance began with two working women who lied to a king and were rewarded for it. |
| The commandments, from the second clause onward. | The preamble — that the authority to command rests on having ended somebody's forced labor. |
| Sabbath as household order and public observance. | Sabbath as a limit on what an owner may extract from a worker, an animal, or a foreigner. |
| The tabernacle chapters — costly, ordered, beautiful worship. | The seventh-year release, the interest ban, and the returned cloak. |
| Moses the lawgiver, obedient and unquestioning. | Moses arguing God out of a decision, twice, and offering to be struck from the book. |

THE SANCTUM'S PROBLEM WITH THIS BOOK

A scripture whose God is introduced as having heard a labor complaint cannot be fully domesticated. Management of that difficulty sits with Prelate Huldah's office — the liberation material is hers to teach, restrict, or spiritualize, and the Empire's handling of Exodus runs through her desk. **[CANON]**

THE EMPIRE'S DELIVERANCE LITURGY — WRITE THE PART A CHARACTER STOPS BELIEVING

# WHAT I TAKE OUT OF EXODUS

WRITING

DOSSIER CLOSE

QUEUE: D2

THE ONE THING THIS BOOK CHANGED ABOUT HOW I SEE DOMINION

WHAT I STILL DO NOT UNDERSTAND — CARRY TO THE RESEARCH LIST

A LINE, AN IMAGE, OR A LAW I AM TAKING STRAIGHT INTO THE MANUSCRIPT

PROOFING GATE

*log only — nothing is closed here*

Dossier II is built at seventeen numbered pages plus this close, with content preparation on EX07 and EX12 and one reserved plate on EX01. Outstanding for the proofing gate: full citations with edition and year for the Exodus margin entries, and artwork.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

SOURCE MARGIN

LEV 1–27

MT · LXX

MILGROM, LEVITICUS (AB)

KLAWANS, IMPURITY AND SIN

PLATE RESERVED

*Leviticus plate not yet supplied — a field edge left unharvested, a scale, a curtain. Drop art here.*

UNFINISHED · ART PENDING

DOSSIER III · ◈

# LEVITICUS

*The book quoted to condemn and never quoted to release. Its most famous verses are three; its longest arguments are about debt, land, wages, and the harvest edge — and an empire that cites it has to keep those chapters out of general circulation.*

### WHY A FULL DOSSIER

The audit assigns it a dossier on two grounds: the body treated as a jurisdiction, and the economic and restorative demands Dominion suppresses. Both are here, at the length they need.

### HOW TO WORK IT

Reference is roughly a third of these pages. The rest is yours. Three pages carry content preparation; skip them if you need to and the dossier still works.

# WHAT IT IS

| | |
|---|---|
| NAME | English from the Greek and Latin, "pertaining to the Levites." Hebrew *Vayikra*, "and he called," the opening word. The Hebrew title names an address; the Greek names a professional class. **[C]** |
| PLACE | Third book of the Torah, set entirely at Sinai. The narrative barely moves: the tabernacle has just been built at the end of Exodus, and Leviticus is what is said from inside it. **[C]** |
| AUTHORSHIP | Traditionally Moses. Modern scholarship generally treats chapters 1–16 and 17–26 as distinct bodies of priestly material, the second often called the Holiness Code, with dates and relative order debated. Not settled. **[R]** |
| STRUCTURE | 1–7 offerings. 8–10 priestly ordination and its first disaster. 11–15 clean and unclean. 16 the Day of Atonement. 17–26 holiness, sexuality, festivals, land, debt, and release. 27 valuations and vows. **[C]** |
| GENRE | Ritual instruction, addressed mostly to priests and sometimes to the whole assembly. It is a procedures manual, not a narrative and not a devotional. Read it the way you would read a professional standard. **[C]** |
| A WARNING | More people quote this book than have read it. Three verses are famous and twenty-seven chapters are not. Any argument built from Leviticus that cannot say what chapter 25 requires is quoting selectively. **[P]** |

### WHAT THE BOOK IS ACTUALLY ABOUT, IF IT IS ABOUT ONE THING

Proximity. What it costs to live near a holy thing, who is admitted, who is put outside for how long, and what has to be given back before anyone can approach again. Holiness in this book is a spatial and economic arrangement, not a mood. **[P]**

### WHAT I WAS TAUGHT LEVITICUS WAS FOR — AND WHICH VERSES I WAS TAUGHT FROM IT

LEV 1.1

LEV 1–16

LEV 17–26

LEV 27

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16 (AB)

TKC: DOM

LEV 1–3

LEV 4–5

LEV 5 .14–6.7

LEV 5 .7–13

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

# A SYSTEM, NOT A MOOD

Five main offerings, each with its own occasion, procedure, and disposal of the parts. Two of them are for wrongdoing; three are not. The sliding scale matters: the same rite can be an ox, a bird, or flour, depending on what the offerer has. Access is priced to income, and the text says so. **[C]**

| OFFERING | WHAT IT IS FOR | WHO EATS |
|---|---|---|
| Burnt · 1 | Wholly given. Not tied to a specific sin; the standing daily offering of the sanctuary. | Nobody — all burned |
| Grain · 2 | A gift from the harvest, with oil and salt, no leaven. The offering available to a household without livestock. | Priests, in part |
| Well-being · 3 | Thanksgiving, vow, or freewill. This is the shared meal — the only offering the offerer's household eats. | The family, with the priests |
| Purification · 4 | Often rendered "sin offering." Its subject is inadvertent wrong and the contamination it leaves on the sanctuary; the rank of the offender changes the procedure. | Priests, in cases |
| Reparation · 5–6 | Wrong involving property, fraud, or a false oath: restore what was taken, add a fifth, then bring the offering. Restitution to the person comes first. **[C]** | Priests |

### THE PART NO EMPIRE PREACHES

In the reparation law, ritual does not substitute for repayment. You cannot settle a defrauded neighbor at the altar; the neighbor is paid first, with a penalty added, and only then is the offering brought. A religion that offers forgiveness without restitution has reversed this chapter. **[P]**

WHAT DOMINION CHARGES FOR ABSOLUTION — AND WHO IS PAID, IF ANYONE

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns disease, bodily discharge, and exclusion from the community, including quarantine language applied to people.

# THE BODY AS JURISDICTION

Impurity in Leviticus is not sin and mostly not moral. It is a status that limits access to the sanctuary, contracted by ordinary events — eating, birth, sex, illness, contact with a corpse — and resolved by time, washing, and sometimes an offering. Translating the terms as “dirty” or “shameful” imports a judgment the system does not make. **[R]**

### WHAT IT ACTUALLY REGULATES

Not who is good, but who may approach, when, and after what interval. Almost everyone is impure at some point, including priests. The system assumes recurrence; it is a calendar of access, not a register of character. **[C]**

### THE SKIN CHAPTERS

Chapters 13–14 give the priest a diagnostic protocol for a scaling skin condition — inspect, isolate, re-inspect after seven days, declare. The word is not modern leprosy; it also applies to fabric and to houses. The priest functions as an inspector with the power to exclude and to readmit, and the readmission rite is as detailed as the exclusion. **[R]**

### DIETARY LAW

Chapter 11 sorts animals by criteria the text states and never explains. Proposals include hygiene, boundary maintenance, and anomaly avoidance; Douglas’s structural reading is the most influential and has been revised, including by her. No explanation is settled, and the text offers only holiness as the reason. **[R]**

### WHERE THE DANGER IS FOR A WRITER

A status system with an inspector, an interval, and a public declaration is the most transferable machinery in the Torah. Dominion does not need to invent contamination law; it only needs to attach moral weight to a status that this book keeps mostly non-moral. **[P]**

WHO INSPECTS BODIES IN DOMINION, AND WHAT THEY ARE AUTHORIZED TO DECLARE

LEV 11

LEV 13–14

LEV 15

DOUGLAS, PURITY AND DANGER

KLAWANS, IMPURITY AND SIN

TKC: DOM

LEV 12

LEV 15 .1–18

LEV 15 .19–33

LUKE 2 .22–24

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: DOM · WOMEN

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns menstruation, childbirth, and the regulation of women's bodies by religious law.

# CHAPTER 12 AND CHAPTER 15

Two chapters govern access after childbirth and during genital discharge, for women and for men. Read them together: the male provisions are there, and are usually left out of any sermon on the female ones. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| AFTER A BIRTH | A period of impurity and then a longer period before sanctuary access, doubled if the child is a girl. The text states the doubling and gives no reason. Any explanation you have heard is interpretation. **[C]** |
| THE OFFERING AFTER BIRTH | A lamb, or two birds if she cannot afford a lamb. The concession is written into the law, which tells you the law expects poor women to be using it. **[C]** |
| MEN IN CHAPTER 15 | Male discharge, including ordinary emission, produces the same kind of temporary impurity, with washing and an interval. The chapter is symmetrical in structure even where the durations differ. **[C]** |
| WHAT IT IS NOT | These states are not punishments and not sins; they are conditions with a procedure. Whether the system nonetheless burdens women more heavily in practice is a fair question and a separate one from what the text calls it. **[P]** |
| RECEPTION | Later Jewish law developed these rules into a detailed practice with its own internal debates, and Christian churches produced separate customs about women after childbirth. Do not read either back into Leviticus as if it were the text. **[R]** |

THE USEFUL QUESTION FOR TKC

Not whether a purity system exists, but who administers the calendar. An empire that decides when a woman may enter a building and when she may not has an instrument for scheduling her whole life, and can attach a fee to it. **[P]**

WHAT MY WORLD DOES WITH A WOMAN'S BODY AND A CALENDAR

# ONE DAY, TWO GOATS

LEV 16

LEV 10 .1–3

LEV 23 .26–32

HEB 9 (RECEPTION)

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: SANCTUM

Once a year the high priest enters the innermost space, after a sequence of washings and changes of clothing, and the sanctuary itself is cleansed of a year's accumulated contamination. Two goats are involved: one is offered, and one is sent away alive into the wilderness carrying what has been confessed over it. The chapter is placed immediately after the deaths of two priests who improvised. **[C]**

> WHAT IS BEING CLEANSED
>
> The building, first. The rite addresses contamination that has collected on the sanctuary because the community lives near it, and then the people. Sin in this chapter has a physical residue, and it is deposited where God is said to dwell. **[C]**

> THE GOAT THAT LEAVES
>
> The second goat is designated by a term whose meaning is disputed — a name, a place, or a phrase about removal — and is led out by a man who then washes and returns. The English "scapegoat" comes from an early translation choice, and the modern social sense of the word is a later development. Do not read the modern meaning back into the verse. **[R]**

> CONFESSION IS SPOKEN ALOUD
>
> The high priest confesses over the animal, in public, on behalf of the whole people, and the assembly does no work and denies itself. A national accounting with a fixed date, performed by the highest office, in the hearing of everyone. **[C]**

> TWO PRIESTS DIED IN CHAPTER 10
>
> Aaron's sons bring unauthorized fire and are killed; Aaron is told to be silent and the mourning rules are suspended for him. The system that follows is written by people for whom improvisation at the altar was lethal. **[C]**

> RECEPTION, MARKED AS SUCH
>
> Later Jewish tradition developed Yom Kippur into the year's central day of repentance without a temple; the letter to the Hebrews reads the chapter christologically. Both are receptions of Leviticus 16, not descriptions of it. **[R]**

DOMINION'S ANNUAL ACCOUNTING — WHO CONFESSES, WHO IS SENT OUT, AND WHO WATCHES

LEV 18

LEV 20

BDB · HALOT TOEVAH

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 17–22 (AB)

SEE PART IV CONTESTED READINGS

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns sexual prohibitions, incest, and capital penalties, and the modern use of two verses against gay people. It reports the text and the state of the argument; it does not adjudicate your theology for you.

# THE THREE VERSES AND THE OTHER SEVENTY

Chapters 18 and 20 are lists: prohibited sexual relations, mostly within extended households, framed at both ends by a warning not to behave like the surrounding nations. Most of the list is incest law addressed to men about the women of their own household. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| WHO IS ADDRESSED | Adult men with household authority. The grammar assumes a male agent throughout, which is itself information about who the law thought could do wrong here. **[C]** |
| WHAT IS IN THE LIST | Relations with close kin by blood and by marriage, with a menstruating woman, with a neighbor's wife, with an animal; child sacrifice to Molech; and the two verses about a man lying with a male. Chapter 20 attaches penalties, several of them capital. **[C]** |
| THE WORD RENDERED "ABOMINATION" | A Hebrew term used across the Bible for a range of offenses including dishonest weights and certain foods. Its force and its exact sense are argued in the lexicons; the English word carries a revulsion the Hebrew may not. Check it before building anything on it. **[R]** |
| 18:22 AND 20:13 | Responsible readings differ sharply: on what act is described, on whether the concern is status, household, or cult, on how the verses relate to modern categories of orientation and identity, and on their standing for communities that do not keep the rest of the code. This is **Contested**. The companion prints the dispute and does not print a verdict. **[R]** |
| THE SELECTION TEST | Anyone citing chapter 18 as binding is also citing the menstruation clause, the Molech clause, and the neighbor's-wife clause, and is standing seven chapters from the debt release. Consistency is the question to ask, and it is a question about the reader, not the text. **[P]** |

WHICH VERSES DOMINION MADE STATUTE, AND WHICH IT LEFT AS SCRIPTURE

# THE CHAPTER NOBODY QUOTES ENTIRE

LEV 19 .9–10

LEV 19 .13–14

LEV 19 .15–18

LEV 19 .33–36

MARK 12 .31

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 17–22

The most quoted line in Leviticus — love your neighbor as yourself — sits in the middle of a chapter of labor law, harvest law, court procedure, and disability provision. In context it is not a sentiment. It is the summary clause of a list of concrete obligations. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| THE HARVEST EDGE | Do not reap to the border of the field, do not strip the vineyard bare, leave the fallen for the poor and the foreigner. Not charity administered by the owner — a standing claim on private production, collected by the poor themselves. **[C]** |
| WAGES SAME DAY | A hired worker's pay may not be held overnight. Wage theft is named as robbery in the same breath as robbery. **[C]** |
| DISABILITY | Do not curse the deaf or put a stumbling block before the blind — prohibitions of harm that the victim cannot see coming or answer. Compare with the priestly blemish rules on LV11: the same book, two different logics. **[C]** |
| COURTS AND SPEECH | No partiality to great or poor, no slander, no profiting from a neighbor's blood, and a duty to reprove rather than hate in your heart. Confrontation is commanded as an alternative to grudge-keeping. **[C]** |
| THE FOREIGNER | The resident foreigner is to be loved as yourself, on the same grounds as the neighbor, with the memory of Egypt as the reason. The famous command is stated twice, and the second time it is about immigrants. **[C]** |
| HONEST WEIGHTS | Just balances, just weights, just measures. Commercial fraud closes the chapter that contains the love command. **[C]** |

### WHAT THIS DOES TO THE FAMOUS VERSE

Read in place, loving a neighbor means leaving crop in your own field, paying on the day, not exploiting a person who cannot retaliate, and using honest scales. A church that can quote the verse and not the field edge has kept the sentiment and dropped the cost. **[P]**

WHERE THE HARVEST EDGE WOULD BE IN MY WORLD — AND WHO FENCED IT

LEV 25 .1–7

LEV 25 .8–17

LEV 25 .23–28

LEV 25 .35–46

BERGSMA, THE JUBILEE FROM LEV TO QUMRAN

TKC: DOM · MEN

# LAND, DEBT, AND RELEASE

Every seventh year the land rests. Every fiftieth year, by proclamation, holdings return to the households that lost them and people in debt servitude go home. The stated ground is ownership: the land is not sold in perpetuity because it is not the seller's to sell, and the people are not sold as chattel because they already belong to the God who brought them out. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| THE SABBATH YEAR | No sowing, no reaping, no harvesting the vines; what grows is food for the household, the workers, the hired laborer, the resident foreigner, the livestock, and the wild animals alike. A year in which the distinction between owner and worker is suspended at the level of food. **[C]** |
| THE FIFTIETH YEAR | Proclaimed with a horn on the Day of Atonement: liberty through the land, each returning to their holding and to their family. The economic reset is announced on the day of national confession, which ties the two together deliberately. **[C]** |
| PRICE MECHANICS | Sale prices are calculated by the number of harvests remaining until the release, and overcharging on that basis is prohibited. What is transacted is a lease of crops, not the freehold. Debt is designed to expire. **[C]** |
| NO INTEREST | Take no interest from an impoverished kinsman; support him so he can live beside you. Credit exists and profit from a neighbor's desperation does not. **[C]** |
| REDEMPTION DUTY | A kinsman may and should buy back a relative's land or freedom. Rescue is a family obligation with a legal form — the machinery Ruth runs on. **[C]** |
| THE BOUNDARY IN IT | The protections are for kin. The same chapter permits permanent enslavement of foreigners and their children. This is the limit of the release and it must be printed, not omitted, whenever the jubilee is praised. **[C]** |
| WAS IT PRACTICED | There is no clear evidence of a jubilee being carried out on this scale, and scholars differ on whether it functioned as enacted law, a utopian program, or a periodically invoked ideal. Later reuse of the language is extensive. **[R]** |

### WHY AN EMPIRE CANNOT CIRCULATE THIS CHAPTER

A permanent land market and inheritable debt are the two mechanisms by which a household is captured for generations. Chapter 25 forbids both among kin, and grounds the ban in the deliverance the Empire also claims. It cannot be denied and it cannot be taught, so it is left in the closed catechism. **[P]**

WHICH HOUSEHOLD IN MY CAST WOULD BE FREED BY A JUBILEE, AND WHO WOULD LOSE BY IT

# BUILD THE SUPPRESSION

WRITING

LEV 19 · LEV 25

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

Dominion cannot delete a chapter that its own scripture contains. It has to manage it: restrict it, spiritualize it, postpone it, or attach conditions that never arrive. Draft the mechanism here.

1 · THE OFFICIAL TEACHING ON DEBT RELEASE — WRITE IT IN THE SANCTUM'S VOICE

2 · THE CONDITION ATTACHED TO IT THAT CAN NEVER BE SATISFIED

3 · A CHARACTER WHO READS CHAPTER 25 FOR THE FIRST TIME — WRITE THE SCENE

4 · THE HARVEST EDGE AND THE SAME-DAY WAGE, AS DOMINION LABOR LAW — WHAT REPLACED THEM

LEV 21 .1–15

LEV 21 .16–24

LEV 22 .10–16

LEV 19 .14

OLYAN, DISABILITY IN THE HEBREW BIBLE

TKC: CT

# THE BODY OF THE OFFICIAL

Chapter 21 restricts who may serve at the altar by descent, by marriage, by mourning conduct, and by body. A priest with a listed physical condition may eat the holy food and may not officiate. The rule concerns the presentation of the sanctuary, and it excludes a class of people from an office on the basis of their bodies. Both halves of that sentence belong on the page. **[C]**

### THE LIST

Blindness, lameness, disfigurement, a limb difference, certain skin conditions, and others. The animals brought are held to a parallel standard. Interpreters note the symmetry between offerer, offering, and officiant; that symmetry is an explanation of the logic, not a justification of it. **[R]**

### HELD AGAINST CHAPTER 19

The same book that protects the deaf and the blind from harm bars them from the priesthood. This is a real tension inside Leviticus, and the honest move is to name it rather than to resolve it in either direction. Olyan is the standard treatment. **[R]**

### PRIESTLY MARRIAGE AND MOURNING

Restrictions on whom a priest may marry, tighter for the high priest, and limits on which corpses he may mourn. A daughter of a priest is covered by a separate and severe clause. Office reaches into the household and the funeral. **[C]**

### WHAT PRIESTS LIVE ON

Portions of the offerings, by rule, with their households included and outsiders excluded. The sanctuary is also a payroll, and the text is unembarrassed about it. **[C]**

### FOR DOMINION

An empire selecting candidates for a public religious role has this chapter available as precedent for physical screening, and the Trials are exactly such a selection. Whether the Sanctum cites Leviticus 21 for its examinations is a plot decision, logged Possible. **[P]**

WHAT DISQUALIFIES A BODY FROM SERVICE IN MY WORLD — AND WHO WROTE THE LIST

# ONE PASSAGE, WORKED PROPERLY



Choose one passage from Leviticus and run the method across this spread. Suggested, if you want one chosen: 25:8–17, the jubilee proclamation, or 19:9–15, the harvest edge and the wage.

SEE PART I METHOD PAGES

PASSAGE

TRANSLATION USED

1 · WHAT IT SAYS — SUMMARIZE WITHOUT INTERPRETING. NO CONCLUSIONS YET.

2 · WHO IS ADDRESSED, WHO IS DISCUSSED, AND WHO IS ABSENT

3 · WHERE TWO TRANSLATIONS DIFFER, AND WHAT TURNS ON THE DIFFERENCE

METHOD

PASSAGE PRACTICE

TKC: DOM · CT

## 4 · HOW THIS PASSAGE HAS BEEN USED AGAINST SOMEONE — AND WHO BENEFITED

## 5 · WHAT IT COSTS THE PERSON WITH PROPERTY, IF IT IS ACTUALLY KEPT

## 6 · WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH IT — CIRCULATE, RESTRICT, OR SPIRITUALIZE

## 7 · WHAT I AM TAKING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHICH CHAPTER

STATUS OF WHAT I JUST WROTE

Anything discovered on these two pages begins as **Possible**. Promote it to Canon only after deciding it belongs in the manuscript and recording where it affects the existing files.

# A BOOK USED IN TWO DIRECTIONS

Reception, marked as reception. Every line below is what people did with Leviticus, not what Leviticus says. **[R]**

| | |
|---|---|
| INSIDE THE BIBLE | Release-and-liberty language from chapter 25 reappears in the prophets, and Luke has Jesus read a release passage aloud in a synagogue and apply it to the present. The jubilee is quoted as a program, not an antique. **[C]** |
| JEWISH PRACTICE | Rabbinic tradition developed the purity, dietary, and agricultural laws into a living body of practice and argument, including sabbatical-year observance still debated today. Leviticus is not a dead text; treating it as one is a Christian habit, not a fact. **[R]** |
| EARLY CHRISTIAN USE | A first-century dispute over which of these laws applied to non-Jewish believers produced a compromise, and later Christian tradition split the code into ceremonial, civil, and moral categories — a distinction the book itself does not make, and the mechanism by which chapter 18 is kept and chapter 25 is dropped. **[R]** |
| JUBILEE IN POLITICS | Abolitionists, land-reform movements, and international debt-cancellation campaigns have all invoked chapter 25 by name, and the word “jubilee” on an American liberty bell comes from this verse. The chapter has a documented political afterlife. **[R]** |
| PURITY AS INSULT | Purity vocabulary has been used to describe people as contaminating — by race, by disease, by sexuality — long after the sanctuary system it belonged to ended. That transfer is the most consequential misuse of this book. **[R]** |

WHERE I HAVE HEARD PURITY LANGUAGE USED ABOUT A PERSON

LEV 25.10

ISA 61 .1–2

LUKE 4 .16–21

ACTS 15

KLAWANS, IMPURITY AND SIN

BERGSMA, THE JUBILEE

LEV 19 .9–15

LEV 25

LEV 6 .1–7

TKC: DOM

TKC: SANCTUM · HULDAH

# THE HALF THE EMPIRE TEACHES

Everything below is a TKC construction to be tested against the manuscript, not a claim about scripture. **[P]**

| WHAT THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES | WHAT IT KEEPS IN THE CLOSED CATECHISM |
|---|---|
| Holiness as personal purity, and the sexual prohibitions as household law. | Chapter 25 entire — land returned, debts ended, servitude terminated by proclamation. |
| Love your neighbor, as a disposition. | The harvest edge, the same-day wage, and the ban on interest that define what the love requires. |
| Inspection, quarantine, and readmission as public health and public order. | That impurity in the source text is temporary, recurring, mostly non-moral, and applies to priests too. |
| Atonement as an annual act of submission scheduled by the Sanctum. | That the rite cleanses the sanctuary of what the institution itself has accumulated. |
| Restitution as a religious offering paid to the Temple. | That the defrauded person is paid first, in full, plus a fifth, before any offering counts. |

THE ONE-PAGE VERSION OF THE ARGUMENT

Dominion does not need to falsify Leviticus. It needs to teach chapters 11 through 20 and shelve chapters 19:9–15 and 25 — keeping the machinery of exclusion and dropping the machinery of release. A character who reads the whole book has found the Empire's own scripture arguing against it, which is a stronger plot device than any invented heresy. **[P]**

WHO IN MY CAST WOULD RATHER NOT HAVE HEARD CHAPTER 25 READ ALOUD

# WHAT I TAKE OUT OF LEVITICUS

WRITING

DOSSIER CLOSE

QUEUE: D3

## THE ONE THING THIS BOOK CHANGED ABOUT HOW I SEE DOMINION

## WHAT I STILL DO NOT UNDERSTAND — CARRY TO THE RESEARCH LIST

## A CLAUSE I AM TAKING STRAIGHT INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHERE

PROOFING GATE

*log only — nothing is closed here*

Dossier III is built at fifteen numbered pages plus the opening, with content preparation on LV04, LV05, and LV07, one reserved plate on LV01, and the 18:22 material carried as **Contested** with no verdict printed. Outstanding for the gate: full citations with edition and year, and artwork.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

SOURCE MARGIN

DEUT 1–34

MT · LXX · 4QDEUT

WEINFELD, DEUT 1–11 (AB)

LEVINSON, DEUT AND THE HERM. OF LEGAL INNOVATION

PLATE RESERVED

*Deuteronomy plate not yet supplied — a river not crossed, a boundary stone, a scroll found in a wall. Drop art here.*

UNFINISHED · ART PENDING

DOSSIER IV · ◈

# DEUTERONOMY

*A speech given by a man who is not allowed to arrive. It is the book that tells a nation how to be a nation — one sanctuary, one archive, a king held under the law, debts that expire — and it is the single most dangerous book in the Torah for an empire to let people read whole.*

### WHY A FULL DOSSIER

The audit assigns it a dossier on three grounds: it is a constitution, it contains the law that limits a king, and it supplies both the covenant-enforcement machinery and the conquest language Dominion runs on. All three are here.

### HOW TO WORK IT

Reference is roughly a third of these pages. The rest is yours. Two pages carry content preparation; skip them if you need to and the dossier still works.

# WHAT IT IS

| | |
|---|---|
| NAME | English from the Greek *Deuteronomion*, "second law" — itself a rendering of a phrase in chapter 17 that more likely meant "a copy of this law." Hebrew *Devarim*, "words." The Greek title is arguably a translation error that became a description. **[R]** |
| PLACE | Fifth and last book of the Torah, set on the far side of the Jordan on the last day of Moses' life. Nothing happens. The whole book is speech, and then a death. **[C]** |
| AUTHORSHIP | Traditionally Moses. Since the early nineteenth century a dominant scholarly view has connected the book's core to the law scroll found in the temple under Josiah, and dated that core to the seventh century; the dating, the extent of the core, and the direction of influence are all argued. Not settled. **[R]** |
| STRUCTURE | 1–4 a retelling of the wilderness. 5–11 the commandments, the Shema, and the sermon on loyalty. 12–26 the law code proper. 27–28 blessings and curses. 29–30 covenant renewal. 31–34 succession, a song, a blessing, a grave. **[C]** |
| GENRE | Sermon around a law code, in a shape that resembles ancient Near Eastern treaties between a great king and a subject people: history, terms, witnesses, blessings, curses. Read it as a founding document with a preacher's voice. **[R]** |
| A WARNING | This book contains the most quoted verse about love of God and the most brutal commands about conquest, in the same speech, from the same mouth. Any presentation that gives you one and not the other is selling you something. **[P]** |

### WHAT THE BOOK IS ACTUALLY ABOUT, IF IT IS ABOUT ONE THING

Memory as a political instrument. Almost every command is attached to a reason that begins *remember that you were slaves*. The book's theory is that a people who forget where they came from will build what they escaped. **[P]**

### WHAT I WAS TAUGHT DEUTERONOMY WAS — AND WHETHER I WAS EVER TOLD IT WAS A CONSTITUTION

DEUT 1.1

DEUT 1–11

DEUT 12–26

DEUT 27–34

2 KGS 22–23

TKC: DOM

DEUT 1–3

DEUT 28

DEUT 31.9–13

ESARHADDON SUCCESSION TREATY (COMPARE)

WEINFELD, DEUT AND THE DEUT SCHOOL

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

# A LOYALTY OATH, REVERSED

Assyrian and Hittite kings bound subject peoples with documents of a recognizable type. Deuteronomy has the same parts in roughly the same order, with one substitution: the great king is God, and the human monarch is demoted into the text as a regulated official. That substitution is the book's central political act. **[R]**

| TREATY PART | WHAT IT DOES | WHERE |
|---|---|---|
| Preamble | Names who is speaking and by what authority. | 1:1–5 |
| Historical prologue | Recites the shared past — favors given, betrayals committed — so the terms arrive as gratitude rather than imposition. Note that this retelling differs from Exodus and Numbers in places; the differences are the argument. | 1:6–3:29 |
| Basic stipulation | Exclusive loyalty. In a political treaty this clause forbids diplomacy with rival powers; here it forbids other gods, in the same vocabulary. | 5–11 |
| Detailed terms | The code: sanctuary, officers, courts, king, priests, prophets, war, property, debt, family, harvest. | 12–26 |
| Deposit and reading | The document is stored beside the ark and read aloud to the whole assembly on a schedule — including women, children, and foreigners. Public reading is written into the law that governs it. | 31:9–13 |
| Witnesses | Where a treaty calls gods to witness, this book calls heaven and earth, and a song to be memorized. | 30:19 · 31:19 |
| Blessings and curses | Enforcement. The curses run far longer than the blessings, and their content parallels known Assyrian curse lists closely enough that the resemblance is standard in the literature. | 27–28 |

### WHY THE FORM MATTERS FOR TKC

If you want to build a state religion, this is the template — and the template is neutral. The same seven parts produce a covenant that limits the king or a loyalty oath that deifies him, depending on who is named in the preamble. Dominion changes one line and keeps the rest. **[P]**

DOMINION'S FOUNDING DOCUMENT — WHO IS IN THE PREAMBLE, AND WHO WITNESSES

# THE HOUSEHOLD IS THE SCHOOL

The book's most famous passage is a loyalty clause followed by an instructional method: recite it, teach it to your children, talk about it sitting and walking and lying down and rising, bind it, write it on the doorframe. It is not a devotional mood. It is a curriculum with a delivery schedule, and it is located in the house rather than the sanctuary. **[C]**

### WHERE RELIGIOUS EDUCATION SITS

With parents, in domestic time, using ordinary conversation. No priest appears in this passage, and no building. An institution that wants a monopoly on teaching has to get around chapter 6, not cite it. **[P]**

### THE CHILD'S QUESTION

Chapter 6 anticipates a child asking what the statutes mean, and prescribes the answer: we were slaves, and we were brought out. The catechism the book builds is historical, not metaphysical — the reason for the law is a memory of servitude. **[C]**

### TWO VERSIONS OF THE COMMANDMENTS

Chapter 5 restates the decalogue with real differences from Exodus 20, the clearest being the reason given for sabbath: creation there, deliverance from slavery here. Same command, two grounds. Worth checking side by side before quoting either as "the" commandment. **[C]**

### RECEPTION, MARKED AS SUCH

These verses became a fixed liturgical recitation in Judaism and are quoted in the gospels as the first commandment. Both are receptions of Deuteronomy 6, and neither is a description of what the chapter meant in its own setting. **[R]**

### THE PART THAT FOLLOWS IT

Immediately after the teaching method comes a warning about prosperity: when you live in houses you did not build and eat from vines you did not plant, you will forget. The book's named enemy is not doubt. It is comfort. **[C]**

WHO IS ALLOWED TO TEACH A CHILD IN MY WORLD — AND WHAT HAPPENS IN THE HOUSE INSTEAD

DEUT 6 .4–9

DEUT 5 .6–21

EXOD 20 .8–11 (COMPARE)

MARK 12 .29–30

DEUT 11 .18–21

TKC: CT · HOUSEHOLD

DEUT 12

DEUT 14 .22–29

DEUT 18 .1–8

2 KGS 23

LEVINSON, LEGAL INNOVATION

TKC: SANCTUM

# CENTRALIZATION AND ITS PRICE

Chapter 12 abolishes local altars and requires sacrifice at one chosen place. That single provision reorganizes an entire society: it moves worship away from the village, concentrates revenue, creates a class of displaced local priests, and turns pilgrimage into infrastructure. The chapter then works through the consequences, which is what makes it legislation rather than preaching. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| THE RULE | Sacrifice only at the place God chooses. Local shrines are to be destroyed, not merely deprecated. The place is never named in the book; the text says "the place he will choose." **[C]** |
| MEAT BECOMES SECULAR | Because you can no longer slaughter at a local altar, the law permits ordinary non-sacrificial slaughter at home. A ritual monopoly at the center produces, as its by-product, a whole domain of life the sanctuary no longer touches. **[C]** |
| TITHE BY CONVERSION | If the journey is too long, sell the tithe, carry the money, and buy what you want at the sanctuary — explicitly including wine and strong drink — and eat it there with your household. Chapter 14 turns a tax in kind into currency for logistical reasons and says so plainly. **[C]** |
| THE THIRD-YEAR TITHE | Every third year the tithe stays in the town and goes to the Levite, the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow. A centralized system with a mandatory local redistribution valve built into it. **[C]** |
| THE DISPLACED PRIESTS | Levites without land appear repeatedly in the lists of the vulnerable, and chapter 18 gives a Levite arriving at the central sanctuary a right to serve and to eat. The reform's own casualties are legislated for — imperfectly, and visibly. **[R]** |
| THE HISTORICAL HOOK | 2 Kings describes Josiah finding a law scroll and then destroying provincial shrines and centralizing Passover at Jerusalem — the program of Deuteronomy 12 executed as policy. Whether the book produced the reform or the reform produced the book is the live question. **[R]** |

### THE MECHANISM WORTH STEALING

One authorized place, one authorized calendar, and travel required to comply. Attendance becomes traceable, absence becomes evidence, and the road itself becomes a tax. Dominion does not have to invent a Sanctum monopoly; it only has to keep chapter 12 and lose chapter 14's local tithe. **[P]**

WHAT THE JOURNEY TO THE CENTER COSTS A POOR HOUSEHOLD IN MY WORLD

# THE KING UNDER THE TEXT

Six verses, and they are the most politically radical passage in the Torah. Monarchy is permitted, conditionally, and then stripped: no cavalry build-up, no return to Egypt for horses, no harem, no accumulation of silver and gold. The king must write out a copy of this law himself and read it all his life, so that his heart is not lifted above his brothers. The office is placed under a document rather than above it. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| HOW THE KING ARRIVES | By popular demand — "like all the nations around us" — and then by divine choice, and he must be from among the people, not a foreigner. Kingship is a concession framed as imitation of neighbors. **[C]** |
| THE FOUR PROHIBITIONS | Horses, Egypt, wives, treasure. Read as policy: no standing cavalry, no foreign military alliance, no dynastic marriage network, no royal capital accumulation. These are precisely the four instruments of ancient state power. **[R]** |
| THE COPYING CLAUSE | He writes the law in a scroll in the presence of the priests and keeps it with him. A sovereign who must personally transcribe the constraints on his office, and reread them, cannot claim not to know them. **[C]** |
| THE STATED REASON | Not efficiency and not piety, but that his heart not be lifted above his brothers. The rationale is anti-hierarchical and is written into the clause. **[C]** |
| THE OTHER OFFICES | Judges, priests, and prophets are each limited in the surrounding chapters — no bribes, no partiality, a test for false prophecy, portions rather than estates. Chapter 17 sits inside a scheme that distributes and checks authority, and Solomon is later described doing all four forbidden things. **[C]** |
| WHAT IS MISSING | No enforcement mechanism. Nobody is named who can remove a king who violates the list, which is the flaw every later empire exploits. The limits are real and unenforceable. **[P]** |

THE CENTRAL TKC FINDING

The Empire's own scripture contains a clause forbidding the Emperor to accumulate wealth, weapons, and women, and requiring him to copy out the law by hand. Dominion cannot delete it. It must reinterpret it — most plausibly by declaring the Emperor exempt as the law's author rather than its subject. That single move is the theological center of the Empire, and it is available to any character who can read. **[P]**

WHICH OF THE FOUR PROHIBITIONS MY EMPEROR BREAKS MOST VISIBLY, AND WHO NOTICED

DEUT 17 .14–20

DEUT 16 .18–20

DEUT 18 .15–22

1 SAM 8

1 KGS 10–11 (COMPARE)

TKC: DOM · THE MEN

DEUT 15 .1–11

DEUT 15 .12–18

DEUT 23 .15–20

DEUT 24 .10–15

JER 34

NEH 5

TKC: DOM

# DEBT WITH AN EXPIRY DATE

Every seventh year, release. Loans among the people are cancelled, debt servants go free, and they do not go empty-handed — the master is required to load them with livestock, grain, and wine, because you were slaves and were brought out. The chapter also legislates against the obvious evasion: do not refuse a loan because the seventh year is near. It anticipates the loophole and closes it. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| THE RELEASE ITSELF | At the end of every seven years, creditors release what they have lent to a fellow member of the people. Foreigners are excepted, and the exception is stated in the text. Print the limit alongside the promise. **[C]** |
| TWO SENTENCES THAT DISAGREE | "There will be no poor among you" and "the poor will never cease from the land" stand a few verses apart. The first is the outcome if the law is kept; the second is the working assumption. The chapter holds a goal and a realism together without resolving them. **[R]** |
| THE HARD HEART CLAUSE | Do not harden your heart or shut your hand; lend willingly and do not let your eye be hostile because the release is coming. Reluctance is named as a sin, which means the drafters expected it. **[C]** |
| SEVERANCE | The freed servant leaves with provisions, generously, from the flock and the threshing floor and the winepress. Manumission with capital, so that freedom is survivable. Compare Exodus 21, where the release exists without the provision. **[C]** |
| THE ONE WHO STAYS | If the servant chooses to remain, an awl through the ear at the door marks it permanently, and the clause covers a woman as well as a man. Consent is provided for and then made irreversible and visible. **[C]** |
| AROUND THE CHAPTER | Interest forbidden among kin, a pledge that may not be taken from the poor and must be returned by nightfall, wages paid the same day, and a runaway slave who may not be handed back — a provision without parallel in the surrounding legal world. **[R]** |
| WAS IT PRACTICED | Jeremiah describes a release enacted and then reversed, with the reversal condemned. Nehemiah describes a debt crisis settled by remission under pressure. Evidence of the law being invoked exists; evidence of it working as designed does not. **[R]** |

### HELD BESIDE LEVITICUS 25

Leviticus returns land every fiftieth year; Deuteronomy cancels debt every seventh. Two different instruments aimed at the same failure — the permanent capture of a household. Together they make generational poverty illegal, which is exactly why an empire teaches neither. **[P]**

HOW DEBT PASSES TO A CHILD IN MY WORLD — AND WHO WROTE THAT RULE

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns commanded killing, the destruction of civilian populations including children, siege warfare, and the capture of women as spoil. It reports the text and the state of the argument; it does not resolve it for you.

# THE COMMANDS NOBODY EMBROIDERS

The same book that says love the foreigner because you were foreigners orders the total destruction of seven named peoples. Both are in it. A companion that prints one and hides the other is not a companion. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| THE DEVOTED THING | A Hebrew term often rendered "utterly destroy" designates persons or property removed from ordinary use by destruction. It is a category of dedication, not a military tactic, and it appears in a neighboring kingdom's royal inscription as well. **[R]** |
| TWO RULES OF WAR | Chapter 20 gives distant cities terms of surrender first, with the surviving population put to forced labor. For the cities of the land itself it commands that nothing breathing be left alive. The law is explicitly two-tier, and the harsher tier is reserved for the closest neighbors. **[C]** |
| THE STATED REASON | Not ethnicity and not land hunger as the text presents it, but contamination: they will teach you their practices. The justification offered is ideological containment, which is the justification every purge has used since. **[C]** |
| EXEMPTIONS AND THE TREES | Men with a new house, a new vineyard, a new marriage, or fear are sent home before battle, and fruit trees may not be cut down for siege works. Restraint and annihilation are drafted by the same hand, on the same page. **[C]** |
| THE CAPTIVE WOMAN | Chapter 21 regulates taking a captive woman as a wife: a month of mourning, a shaved head, and if she is later rejected she must be freed rather than sold. It is a restriction on a practice it permits. Whether that is mitigation or legitimation is a genuine dispute, and both readings are serious. **[R]** |
| DID IT HAPPEN | Archaeology does not support a sweeping military conquest of the kind Joshua narrates, and many scholars read these commands as retrospective ideology written long after, aimed at internal loyalty rather than at actual campaigns. That reading explains the text's origin; it does not soften the words on the page. This is **Contested**, and the companion prints the dispute without a verdict. **[R]** |

WHAT DOMINION DOES WITH A DIVINE WAR COMMAND — AND WHICH OF MY CHARACTERS CARRIED IT OUT

DEUT 7 .1–6

DEUT 20

DEUT 21 .10–14

JOSH 6–11 (RECEPTION)

MESHA STELE (COMPARE)

SEE PART IV CONTESTED READINGS

DEUT 22 .13–21

DEUT 22 .22–29

DEUT 24 .1–4

DEUT 24 .17–22

MATT 19 .3–9 (RECEPTION)

TKC: WOMEN II

CONTENT PREPARATION

This page concerns rape law, virginity evidence, capital penalties, and divorce, including a clause that compels marriage to an assailant.

# WHOSE PROPERTY IS INJURED

The sexual and family laws are addressed to men and largely structured around damage to a household's standing. Reading them as an ethic of consent produces nonsense; reading them as property and lineage law produces a coherent and disturbing system. **[C]**

| | |
|---|---|
| THE CLOTH | A husband alleging his bride was not a virgin triggers a proceeding in which her parents produce evidence at the town gate; if he is lying he is fined and may never divorce her, and if the charge stands she is executed. The procedure treats her reputation as her father's asset and her body as evidence. **[C]** |
| THE FIELD AND THE CITY | An assault on a betrothed woman in open country is treated as her innocence presumed, because no one could hear her cry out; in a town, both are executed. Geography functions as evidence in the absence of testimony. **[C]** |
| THE FIFTY SHEKELS | A man who seizes an unbetrothed woman pays her father and must marry her, with no right of divorce. The remedy is directed to the father and the outcome binds her to the man for life. Naming this plainly is not editorializing; it is reading the clause. **[C]** |
| DIVORCE | Chapter 24 assumes a man may dismiss a wife with a written document, and legislates only that he may not take her back after she has remarried. The ground for dismissal is a vague phrase argued over for two thousand years, and the later dispute in the gospels is a dispute about this verse. **[R]** |
| WHAT CUTS THE OTHER WAY | The same chapters protect a new husband from conscription for a year for his wife's sake, forbid taking a widow's garment in pledge, and require leaving harvest for the widow and the orphan. Protection and subordination are not alternatives here; they are the same code. **[C]** |
| HOW TO CITE IT HONESTLY | Comparative work shows these provisions are often less severe than neighboring codes on some points and more severe on others. "Better than its neighbors" and "good" are different claims, and the companion makes only the first where the evidence supports it. **[R]** |

WHICH OF THESE CLAUSES DOMINION KEPT AS STATUTE — AND WHO IS STANDING AT THE GATE

# WRITE THE EXEMPTION

WRITING

DEUT 17 · DEUT 15

TKC: DOM · THE MEN

Dominion holds a scripture that forbids its Emperor to hoard, to marry widely, and to arm without limit — and requires him to copy the law in his own hand. Build the doctrine that makes that clause harmless without denying it.

1 · THE SANCTUM'S OFFICIAL READING OF THE LAW OF THE KING — IN ITS OWN VOICE

2 · THE COPYING RITE AS THEATRE — WHAT THE EMPEROR ACTUALLY TRANSCRIBES, AND WHO HOLDS THE PEN

3 · THE SCENE WHERE SOMEONE READS THE FOUR PROHIBITIONS ALOUD IN COURT

4 · THE PUBLIC READING EVERY SEVEN YEARS — WHAT DOMINION SUBSTITUTED FOR IT

DEUT 27

DEUT 28

DEUT 30 .1–20

ESARHADDON SUCCESSION TREATY (COMPARE)

JOB · ECCL (DISSENT)

TKC: DOM

# ENFORCEMENT

Fourteen verses of blessing, then more than four times as many of curse: disease, siege, deportation, madness, children eaten in famine. The whole assembly is made to answer *amen* to each curse aloud from two facing mountains. Consent to the penalty clause is obtained ritually and in public. **[C]**

### THE TWELVE CURSES OF CHAPTER 27

Idols made in secret, dishonoring a parent, moving a boundary marker, misleading a blind traveler, perverting justice for the vulnerable. Almost every one names an act done where nobody can see it. The curse list is a mechanism for offenses that evade courts. **[C]**

### THE ASYMMETRY IS THE POINT

Blessing is brief and generic; cursing is long and specific. A document that spends four times as many words on punishment as on reward is telling you what its drafters expected to need. **[P]**

### THE ASSYRIAN PARALLEL

Sequences of curses in Assyrian loyalty documents run close to this chapter in both content and order, closely enough that direct literary relationship is widely argued and the direction of borrowing is debated. The Bible's enforcement language is written in the diplomatic idiom of the empires around it. **[R]**

### WHAT IT DOES TO SUFFERING

If disaster is a penalty clause, then every plague, defeat, and famine becomes evidence of guilt. The prophets use this logic; Job and parts of Ecclesiastes refuse it. The Bible argues with itself here, and this chapter is one side of that argument. **[R]**

### CHOOSE LIFE

Chapter 30 ends the sequence by insisting the command is not too hard and not far off, that it is in the mouth and the heart, and that the choice is set before them. The book closes its own threat with an argument for capability, and then adds a promise of return after exile — a clause written by people who already knew about exile. **[R]**

### THE INSTRUMENT DOMINION INHERITS

A liturgy in which the population says *amen* to its own punishment converts obedience into self-administration, and any subsequent misfortune into proof of a prior offense. An empire holding this chapter never has to explain a famine. It only has to ask what the people did. **[P]**

HOW MY WORLD EXPLAINS ITS LAST DISASTER — AND WHO WAS BLAMED FOR IT

# ONE PASSAGE, WORKED PROPERLY

Choose one passage from Deuteronomy and run the method across this spread. Suggested, if you want one chosen: 17:14–20, the law of the king, or 15:1–11, the release.

PASSAGE

TRANSLATION USED

1 · WHAT IT SAYS — SUMMARIZE WITHOUT INTERPRETING. NO CONCLUSIONS YET.

2 · WHO IS ADDRESSED, WHO IS DISCUSSED, AND WHO IS ABSENT

3 · WHERE TWO TRANSLATIONS DIFFER, AND WHAT TURNS ON THE DIFFERENCE



SEE PART I METHOD PAGES

METHOD

PASSAGE PRACTICE

TKC: DOM · CT

## 4 · HOW THIS PASSAGE HAS BEEN USED AGAINST SOMEONE — AND WHO BENEFITED

## 5 · WHAT IT COSTS THE PERSON IN POWER, IF IT IS ACTUALLY KEPT

## 6 · WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH IT — CIRCULATE, RESTRICT, OR SPIRITUALIZE

## 7 · WHAT I AM TAKING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHICH CHAPTER

STATUS OF WHAT I JUST WROTE

Anything discovered on these two pages begins as **Possible**. Promote it to Canon only after deciding it belongs in the manuscript and recording where it affects the existing files.

# THE BOOK THAT WROTE THE REST

Reception, marked as reception. Every line below is what people did with Deuteronomy, not what Deuteronomy says. **[R]**

| | |
|---|---|
| A SCROLL IN A WALL | 2 Kings tells of a law book discovered during temple repairs, read to the king, and answered with a national purge of shrines. Whatever the scroll was, the narrative makes a found document the trigger for a political revolution — the single most useful plot mechanism in the Hebrew Bible. **[C]** |
| THE HISTORY IT SHAPED | Joshua through Kings is widely read as a single history written from this book's standards, grading each king by whether he tolerated local shrines. The books that look like national chronicle are closer to an audit against a statute. **[R]** |
| IN THE GOSPELS | Jesus answers the wilderness temptations with three lines from this book and names its loyalty clause the first commandment. Deuteronomy is the text he quotes most in argument. **[C]** |
| COVENANT AS POLITICS | Reformation-era and colonial covenant theology, national fast days, and settler charters drew on this book's structure — chosen people, promised land, blessing conditional on obedience. Its conquest chapters were read as precedent by people arriving on other people's land. **[R]** |
| AND THE OTHER WAY | The same book supplied the sabbath-as-liberation argument, the same-day wage, debt cancellation, and the runaway-slave clause to abolitionists and labor movements. Deuteronomy is cited by the conqueror and by the freed in the same century, from the same volume. **[R]** |

WHERE A FOUND DOCUMENT COULD OVERTURN SOMETHING IN MY MANUSCRIPT

2 KGS 22–23

JOSH–KGS (DTR)

MATT 4.1–11

DEUT 6.5 · MARK 12.29

ROM 10.6–8

TKC: DOM · EMPIRE

DEUT 17 .14–20

DEUT 15

DEUT 31 .9–13

DEUT 28

TKC: DOM

TKC: SANCTUM · HULDAH

# THE HALF THE EMPIRE TEACHES

Everything below is a TKC construction to be tested against the manuscript, not a claim about scripture. **[P]**

| WHAT THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES | WHAT IT KEEPS IN THE CLOSED CATECHISM |
|---|---|
| One sanctuary, one calendar, one authorized place of offering. | The third-year tithe that stays in the town, and the tithe converted to coin and eaten by the household itself. |
| The curses of chapter 28, as the explanation for every plague and defeat. | That the same covenant makes the sovereign a subject of the document, with four named prohibitions. |
| Obedience taught as loyalty to the Sanctum's reading of the law. | That the law is to be read aloud to the entire assembly — women, children, and foreigners included — on a fixed schedule. |
| The conquest chapters, as precedent for cleansing a province. | The clause forbidding the return of a runaway slave, and the ban on interest among kin. |
| Instruction as the office of the Sanctum, delivered in its buildings. | That chapter 6 puts teaching in the house, in the parents' mouths, with no priest present. |

THE ONE-PAGE VERSION OF THE ARGUMENT

Dominion keeps Deuteronomy's enforcement and drops its constitution. The curses, the central sanctuary, and the war commands stay in general circulation; the law of the king, the seventh-year release, the household school, and the mandatory public reading go into the closed catechism. The Empire is not opposed by a competing scripture. It is opposed by the second half of its own. **[P]**

WHO IN MY CAST HAS READ CHAPTER 17 — AND WHAT THEY DID THE DAY AFTER

# WHAT I TAKE OUT OF DEUTERONOMY

WRITING

DOSSIER CLOSE

QUEUE: D4

THE ONE THING THIS BOOK CHANGED ABOUT HOW I SEE DOMINION

WHAT I STILL DO NOT UNDERSTAND — CARRY TO THE RESEARCH LIST

A CLAUSE I AM TAKING STRAIGHT INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHERE

PROOFING GATE

*log only — nothing is closed here*

Dossier IV is built at fifteen numbered pages plus the opening, with content preparation on DT08 and DT09, one reserved plate on DT01, and the conquest material carried as **Contested** with no verdict printed. Outstanding for the gate: full citations with edition and year, and artwork.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

# II

PART TWO · ❖

# THE PEOPLE OF THE TEXT

❖

*Almost everyone in this book has been flattened into a lesson by somebody who needed them to mean one thing. Go back and find out what they actually did.*


| | |
|---|---|
| i · How to Read a Person | 100 |
| ii · The Women | 101 |
| iii · The Men | 131 |
| iv · Who Echoes Whom | 152 |

# HOW TO READ A PERSON

Every profile in this part runs the same six fields, and the order matters. It starts with what the person has been reduced to, because that reduction is what you inherited and it will keep steering your instincts until it is written down and looked at. Then the text itself — only what is on the page, including the parts inconvenient for everyone.

Then the Empire's use of them, because Dominion has a position on each of these people, and a state that quotes scripture is always also curating a gallery of approved and cautionary lives. Then the echoes in your own cast, then — most importantly — where the parallel breaks, because that break is where your character stops being a reference and starts being a person.

| | |
|---|---|
| USUALLY REDUCED TO | The received version — the sermon, the flannelgraph, the insult the name has become. |
| WHAT THE TEXT GIVES | Only what is written, with the silences marked as silences rather than filled in. |
| WHAT DOMINION DOES | The Empire's official reading, and what it needs that reading to authorise. |
| TKC ECHOES | Which of your characters this illuminates, and in which specific scene. |
| WHERE IT BREAKS | The mandatory field. No character is an allegory; the difference is the character. |
| QUESTIONS & NOTES | Yours. Nothing printed here has any claim on it. |

**A NOTE ON THE UNNAMED**

A great many women in this collection are given no name — Jephthah's daughter, Lot's wife, the woman of Judges 19, the bleeding woman, the Samaritan at the well. The namelessness is itself information: about who was doing the recording, and about what a system finds worth writing down. When you build Dominion's archives, decide who gets a name in them.

# HAGAR *Genesis 16 · 21*

Egyptian · enslaved · surrogate · the first person in scripture to name God

OT · CHARACTER

THEMES

Surrogacy · exile · being seen · the used body

MARGINALIA

### USUALLY REDUCED TO

A subplot. The servant who caused trouble, the mistake made while waiting on a promise, the woman whose son was not the chosen one.

### WHAT THE TEXT GIVES US

An enslaved foreign woman handed to her mistress's husband as a reproductive instrument, with no recorded consent and no line of dialogue until she is already pregnant and being mistreated. She runs. In the desert she is met, addressed by name, given a promise about her own descendants — and told to go back. Later, when the legitimate son is born, she and her child are expelled with bread and a skin of water, and she puts him under a bush because she cannot watch him die. And she is the one who names God: *the God who sees.* Nobody in Genesis, not Abraham, not Sarah, does that.

### WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH HER

Make her a warning about the servant who forgets her place, and cite the instruction to return as proof that God restores women to the households they flee. Her naming of God is not taught at all.

### TKC ECHOES

Any woman in your book whose body is the instrument of someone else's covenant. The candidate who is used and then surplus. Leah, if Leah has ever been sent away and come back.

### WHERE THE PARALLEL BREAKS

Hagar is met in the wilderness and survives it twice. If your character runs and no one meets her, that is a different theology, and you should know which one you are writing.

### QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

*write here*

✣ *See also:* Genesis, p. 012; Sex & the Body, p. 300.

# TAMAR *Genesis 38*

Twice widowed · defrauded of her legal claim · declared righteous by the man who wronged her

OT · CHARACTER

THEMES

Legal limbo · evidence · veiling · vindication

MARGINALIA

### USUALLY REDUCED TO

A scandal, skipped in public reading. If she is mentioned, she is the woman who pretended to be a prostitute.

### WHAT THE TEXT GIVES US

A woman married into a family, widowed, married to the next brother by law, widowed again, and then sent back to her father's house while the family quietly withholds the third son — leaving her in permanent legal limbo, neither wife nor free. She has no court to appeal to. So she veils herself, positions herself on the road her father-in-law will travel, and takes his seal, his cord and his staff as a pledge. When she is later accused of immorality and sentenced to burn, she produces the three items. He says aloud that she is more righteous than he is, and the text agrees. Her son enters the royal line.

### WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH HER

Omit her. There is no usable version of a story in which a woman entraps a patriarch, is vindicated by the record, and is written into the ancestry of kings. If pressed, the Ministry treats her as an irregularity God permitted.

### TKC ECHOES

Any woman in your novel who has no legal standing and therefore has to create evidence. Note the mechanism: she does not accuse, she collects. Documentation as the only available weapon.

### WHERE THE PARALLEL BREAKS

Tamar's society has a law on her side that is simply not being enforced. If Dominion's law is against your character rather than merely ignored, she cannot win by producing evidence — she has to change the court.

### QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

*write here*

✣ *See also:* Prophecy & Who Gets Believed, p. 315.

# DEBORAH *Judges 4–5*

Prophet · judge · war leader · the problem no empire has solved

OT · DOMINION

THEMES

Authority · office · the exception clause

MARGINALIA

### USUALLY REDUCED TO

An exception. The woman God used because no man was available — a reading the text does not support anywhere.

### WHAT THE TEXT GIVES US

A woman already holding two offices when we meet her: prophet, and judge of the whole nation, hearing cases under a tree. No apology is offered and no crisis is cited to excuse it. She summons the general; he refuses to go to war unless she comes with him; she goes, and tells him the glory will go to a woman instead. It does — a civilian named Jael kills the enemy commander in her own tent. Then Deborah composes the victory song, among the oldest poetry in the Bible, and calls herself a mother in Israel.

### WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH HER

Emergency doctrine. She is taught as a temporary provision for a lawless age — evidence that when men fail, God shames them by using a woman. That converts her authority into an insult aimed at men rather than a precedent for women.

### TKC ECHOES

The woman who holds real authority and is constantly called an exception so the rule survives. Also the general: a man who will only act if a woman stands beside him, and resents her for it afterwards.

### WHERE THE PARALLEL BREAKS

Deborah is never punished, never diminished, and never justifies herself. If your character's authority costs her something, that cost is your invention — worth being honest about, because scripture did not require it.

### QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

*write here*

✣ *See also:* Judges, p. 018; Women Speaking, p. 010.

# RAHAB · RUTH

*Two foreign women who talk their way into the royal genealogy*

## RAHAB

*Joshua 2 · 6*

**Reduced to:** her profession, permanently. She is almost never named without it.

**The text:** she runs a house on the city wall, which means she hears everything and answers to no husband. When two spies arrive she hides them, lies to the king's men to their faces, and then delivers a political assessment more accurate than anything her own government has produced — she knows the war is lost and says so. Then she negotiates: my whole household, in writing, or no deal. She gets it. The wall falls and her house is the one thing left standing.

**Dominion:** useful only as a conversion story — the fallen woman who chose correctly. Never as a woman who conducted foreign policy from a brothel.

**TKC:** the informant. A woman whose survival depends on knowing which way a war is going before the men in charge do. *Breaks:* Rahab's intelligence is believed. Ask whether yours would be.

## RUTH

*Ruth 1–4*

**Reduced to:** a wedding reading. Loyal, gentle, rewarded with a husband.

**The text:** a Moabite widow with no obligation to anyone, who binds herself to her mother-in-law in the most famous vow of devotion in scripture — spoken by a woman, to a woman. She then works a field as a foreign labourer under legal protections she is only just entitled to, and on Naomi's explicit coaching goes to a man at night on the threshing floor and asks him, directly, to marry her. She is the one who proposes. The book calls it loyalty, not scandal.

**Dominion:** the model immigrant — the outsider who assimilates completely and is rewarded. The threshing floor is retold as modesty; the vow is reassigned to a husband.

**TKC:** two women running a survival strategy together, with the older one designing it. *Breaks:* Ruth's gamble works because one man chooses to honour a law he could have ignored.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

# BATHSHEBA · TAMAR OF THE PALACE

*What the court does to a woman it has already harmed*

## BATHSHEBA

*2 Samuel 11–12 · 1 Kings 1–2*

**Reduced to:** a temptress on a roof. Centuries of preaching have made her the cause of a king's fall.

**The text:** she is bathing, as required, in her own home. Every verb in the passage belongs to the king: he saw, he sent, he took. She has no recorded speech until she reports a pregnancy in five words. Her husband is then killed by state order, with the order carried in his own hand. The prophet's parable calls her a lamb and the king a rich man with flocks — the text is explicit about who had power. Her first child dies. Decades later she reappears as a political operator who secures the throne for her son.

**Dominion:** keeps the roof, drops the verbs. A woman's visible body explains a powerful man's decision, which is the single most useful doctrine a court can have.

**TKC:** the official version versus the record. *Breaks:* Bathsheba survives into power. Ask what that costs, and what she becomes.

## TAMAR

*2 Samuel 13*

**Reduced to:** nothing. Most people raised in church have never heard of her.

**The text:** a princess, summoned to a brother's sickroom by her father's own instruction, and raped there. She argues first — reasons with him, offers him a legal alternative, tells him this is not done here — and is not listened to. Afterwards she tears her robe and goes through the city crying out publicly, which is a legal act, not hysteria. Her full brother tells her to be quiet. Her father is furious and does nothing. The text says she remained desolate in her brother's house, and that is the last line she gets. The vengeance that follows is about male honour, not her.

**Dominion:** never reads it aloud. A story in which a king suppresses his daughter's assault to protect the succession is not survivable material for a dynasty.

**TKC:** the buried case. *Breaks:* Tamar's outcry changes nothing. If your character's does, you have chosen mercy — earn it.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

# JEZEBEL · ATHALIAH · HULDAH · VASHTI

*Four women with public power, and four different ways of handling that in the record*

| | |
|---|---|
| JEZEBEL<br>*1 Kings 16–21* | A foreign queen who imports her own religion and runs the state when her husband sulks. She forges his seal to have a man judicially murdered for a vineyard — the crime is real and the text does not soften it. She dies thrown from a window, and paints her eyes first, which is usually read as vanity and is just as easily read as meeting death in full regalia.<br>**Dominion:** the name becomes an insult meaning any woman with influence. Note what the insult accomplishes: it makes *power* the sin, not the murder. |
| ATHALIAH<br>*2 Kings 11* | The only woman to rule the southern kingdom outright, for six years. She takes the throne by killing rivals — exactly as her male predecessors did — and is removed by a priest-led coup that installs a seven-year-old. Her reign is recorded as usurpation; the identical conduct in men is recorded as accession.<br>**Dominion:** proof that female rule ends in blood. **TKC:** the double standard, written into the state's own history. |
| HULDAH<br>*2 Kings 22* | A scroll is found in the temple and the king sends the high priest and the royal secretary to a woman prophet to inquire of God concerning its words. She does not merely certify the document — she delivers an oracle on what it says and what is coming, and the greatest religious reform in the kingdom's history proceeds after her ruling. She is consulted, not permitted. Nobody comments on her being a woman.<br>**Dominion:** she is simply not in the syllabus. Royal and priestly officials seeking a woman's authoritative interpretation of scripture is the one precedent a Ministry cannot allow. **TKC:** your most dangerous single verse. |
| VASHTI<br>*Esther 1* | Summoned to appear before a hall of drunk officials and refuses. The king's advisers panic — not about one marriage, but about precedent: if the queen refuses, every wife in the empire will hear about it. So the refusal is answered with legislation. She is deposed by decree and never mentioned again, and the entire plot of the book is only possible because of the vacancy she creates.<br>**Dominion:** the standing warning, taught immediately before Esther as the contrast. **TKC:** the woman erased in chapter one whose absence the whole story runs on. |

WHICH OF THESE FOUR IS IN DOMINION'S SYLLABUS, AND HOW IS SHE TAUGHT *write here*

# MARY

*of Nazareth · Luke 1–2 · John 2 · 19*

A pregnant teenager who sings about regime change

NT · DOMINION

THEMES

Consent · reversal · the sanitised woman

MARGINALIA

USUALLY REDUCED TO

Serenity. A statue in blue, silent, compliant — the entire personality reduced to one word of consent.

WHAT THE TEXT GIVES US

A girl who is told the plan and asks a practical question about it before agreeing. She then travels alone to another woman's house and stays three months, and the song she sings there is the most politically dangerous passage in the gospels: the powerful pulled off their thrones, the rich sent away empty, the hungry filled. It is in the past tense, as though already done. Later she is a mother who tells him to fix the wine and is not asked twice, who turns up with the family to take him home because they think he has lost his mind, and who stands at the execution when most of the men have gone.

WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH HER

Build the whole doctrine of womanhood on her single yes, and set the song to music so gently that nobody hears the words. Obedient vessel, permanently young, endlessly reproduced in plaster. The revolution she sings is footnoted as spiritual.

TKC ECHOES

Eden, if Eden ever says yes to something enormous while understanding the cost. And the political trick your Empire runs constantly: taking a woman's most radical words and teaching them as her most submissive.

WHERE THE PARALLEL BREAKS

Her consent is asked for. That is the whole hinge — an angel waits for an answer. If Dominion asks nobody's consent for anything, then every ceremony it stages in Mary's name is a lie it tells about its own founding story.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

✣ *See also:* Luke, p. 033; Eden's dossier, p. 248.

# MARY MAGDALENE · THE WOMAN AT THE WELL

*Two women sent to speak, and what got said about them afterwards*

## MARY MAGDALENE

*all four gospels*

**Reduced to:** a prostitute. The text never says this once. It was assigned to her by a sermon centuries later, by conflating her with an unnamed woman in a different chapter, and it stuck so hard that it survived the official correction.

**The text:** a woman healed, who then funds the operation out of her own resources, is named first in the lists of women, stays at the execution, and is the first person to see him alive. In one gospel she is explicitly commissioned — go and tell — which makes her the first witness and the first sent. She tells the men. They do not believe her.

**Dominion:** keep the sinner, drop the commission. A repentant woman is a useful model; a woman whose testimony founds the faith is a constitutional problem.

**TKC:** the reputation assigned retroactively, and the witness disbelieved by the men she was sent to. *Breaks:* she is vindicated by the events themselves. Yours may not be.

## THE WOMAN AT THE WELL

*John 4 · unnamed*

**Reduced to:** her marital history. Five husbands, therefore loose — a reading that ignores that women in that world did not divorce men, men divorced women, and that being passed through five households is a description of misfortune, not appetite.

**The text:** the longest theological conversation in the gospels, and it is with a foreign woman at midday. She argues. She raises the contested question of which mountain is the legitimate place of worship — a political dispute, not small talk — and she is answered seriously. Then she goes back to town and the text says the people believed because of her word. She is the first evangelist in that gospel, and she is never given a name.

**Dominion:** preach the five husbands, skip the theology. A woman debating doctrine with authority and winning a town is not a story a Ministry can survive telling.

**TKC:** the unnamed woman who asks the sharpest question in the book. *Breaks:* she gets a real answer. Ask who in Dominion would answer her.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

# THE WOMEN WHO RAN THINGS

*Named, titled, and working — in the same letters used to silence women*

One fact worth writing on the inside of your skull: the letters containing the silencing verses also greet a long list of women by name, with job titles. Any institution has to choose which list is the rule.

| | |
|---|---|
| PHOEBE<br>*Romans 16* | Called a deacon of her congregation and a patron — a word for someone who funds and protects a group. She carries the letter to Rome, which in practice means she read it aloud and answered questions about it. Most translations quietly render her title *servant*. |
| JUNIA<br>*Romans 16* | Greeted as outstanding among the apostles, and imprisoned for it. For centuries her name was printed as a man's, on no manuscript evidence, because commentators could not accept a female apostle. A translation decision, visible in the fossil record. |
| PRISCILLA<br>*Acts 18 · Romans 16* | A teacher who, with her husband, corrects a gifted male preacher's theology in private — and she is named first in most greetings, which in that convention means she was the more prominent of the pair. A woman instructing a man in doctrine, in the book Dominion cites to forbid it. |
| LYDIA<br>*Acts 16* | A merchant in purple cloth — a luxury trade, so she has money and her own household. She is the first convert in Europe, and she immediately makes her house the base of operations, effectively hiring the movement. No husband is mentioned. The patron. Your resistance needs one. |
| TABITHA<br>*Acts 9* | The only person in the New Testament given the feminine form of *disciple* as a title. She runs what amounts to a widows' network, clothing women with no income. When she dies the widows produce the garments as evidence of what has been lost. Mutual aid, organised by women, recorded as ministry. |
| THE WIDOWS<br>*Acts 6 · 1 Tim 5* | An enrolled order with an age requirement and a register — a formal institutional role for unattached women, with resources attached. The movement's first recorded internal dispute is over whether widows of one language group are being shortchanged in the food distribution. Provision as a political question, from day one. |

> WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH THIS LIST
>
> Print the greetings and never gloss them. Render every title as a domestic word — servant, helper, hostess — and teach the two silencing verses as the law. The list stays in the canon and out of the commentary, which is all that has ever been required.

WHO IS MY PHOEBE, MY LYDIA, MY JUNIA *write here*

# THE FOUNDERS

*Abraham · Jacob · Joseph · Moses — and what the household costs*

Read the men of Genesis and Exodus for one thing above all: the founders of the faith are not presented as moral exemplars. They are presented, with startling candour, as men whose obedience repeatedly endangers the people in their care. An empire that calls itself their heir has to decide whether to keep that candour.

## ABRAHAM

*Genesis 12–25*

Held up as the model of faith, and the text records him twice passing his wife off as his sister to save his own life, expelling an enslaved woman and their child into a desert at his wife's request, and walking his son up a mountain with a knife because he was told to. He also argues God down over the fate of a city, which is the only time he negotiates on anyone's behalf but his own.

**Dominion:** obedience without question, illustrated by the mountain. The bargaining over the city is never preached, because it teaches that God can be argued with.

## JACOB

*Genesis 25–35*

A deceiver who steals a blessing, is deceived in turn over which sister he marries, and spends twenty years in a rigged labour arrangement with his father-in-law. He runs a household of four women in open competition for his attention and does nothing to manage the damage. He is renamed after wrestling all night with something he cannot beat, and he limps afterwards.

**For TKC:** the favouritism engine. A house where love is unequally distributed and the children inherit the grudge — your candidate system in miniature.

## JOSEPH

*Genesis 37–50*

Trafficked by his brothers, imprisoned on a false accusation, and then raised to run an empire's food supply — where he administers a famine policy that ends with the entire population selling first their livestock, then their land, then themselves to the crown for grain. The text reports this without comment. The favourite son becomes the architect of national servitude, and the book that follows opens with his descendants enslaved.

**For TKC:** the competent administrator whose competence builds the machine. The most useful man in this section for writing Dominion's civil service.

## MOSES

*Exodus–Deuteronomy*

Raised inside the palace of the regime that is killing his people, which makes him neither fully one nor the other. He kills a man, flees, and spends forty years as a shepherd before being conscripted. He argues with God constantly — about his own inadequacy, about the mission, and once, remarkably, talks God out of destroying the people. He never enters the land.

**For TKC:** the insider raised by the system he ends up dismantling. Note that his authority is repeatedly challenged and he is never wholly trusted.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

# DAVID

*1 Samuel 16 – 1 Kings 2*

The man every scriptural monarchy in history has claimed as precedent

OT · DOMINION

THEMES

Anointing · impunity · succession · the useful hero

MARGINALIA

### USUALLY REDUCED TO

A boy with a sling, a psalmist with a harp, and a man after God's own heart. Three images, all from the first third of his story.

### WHAT THE TEXT GIVES US

The most fully drawn character in the Old Testament, and the portrait is not flattering. A gifted musician and a genuinely brilliant political operator. A guerrilla commander who runs a protection racket in the wilderness and takes payment from a woman whose husband refuses to pay it. A king who dances half-dressed in public and humiliates his wife for objecting. A man who sees a woman from a roof, sends for her, and has her husband killed by written order. A father whose daughter is raped by his son and who does nothing, and whose kingdom is nearly taken by another son as a result. He dies giving his heir a list of people to kill.

### WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH HIM

Everything. He is the load-bearing figure: divinely chosen, anointed by a prophet, forgiven after private repentance, and promised an eternal dynasty. That promise is the legal basis of every throne that has ever called itself Christian. His crimes are taught as a lesson in personal repentance, never as a case for accountability.

### TKC ECHOES

Your Emperor, and the founding myth he is measured against. Also Judah, if Judah is being trained into a role built on a man whose worst acts are in the official record and forgiven in advance.

### WHERE THE PARALLEL BREAKS

A prophet walks into his throne room, tells him what he did, and lives. That single scene is the difference between a monarchy with a conscience mechanism and one without. Decide whether Dominion has kept it.

### QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL

*write here*

✣ *See also:* Samuel, p. 020; Bathsheba, p. 105; Power & Kingship, p. 307.

# THE MEN WHO SPOKE, AND THE MEN WHO RAN IT

*Prophets against priests — the oldest fight in the collection*

| | |
|---|---|
| SAMUEL<br>*1 Samuel* | The kingmaker. He warns the people exactly what a monarchy will cost them, anoints one anyway, and then spends the rest of his life managing the man he installed. He also anoints the replacement while the first king is still alive. The cleric who makes rulers and outlives them — your Ministry's founding archetype. |
| NATHAN<br>*2 Samuel 12* | Walks into the palace, tells the king a story about a rich man stealing a poor man's lamb, waits for the king to condemn the rich man, and then says: that is you. He survives. Later he manoeuvres in the succession fight. The only accountability mechanism in the monarchy is one man's nerve and a well-built parable. |
| ELIJAH<br>*1 Kings 17–19* | Confronts a king and queen head-on, wins a public contest, kills the opposing prophets, and then collapses — asks to die, and is answered not with rebuke but with food, sleep, and a voice that is not in the storm. The burnout after the victory. Useful for anyone in your book who wins and then cannot get out of bed. |
| JEREMIAH<br>*Jeremiah* | Tried for treason by his own government for saying the city would fall, thrown into a cistern, and proved right. He hates the job and says so, bitterly, on the record. The dissident the state processes through its own courts — and the one whose scroll it burns. |
| AARON & THE PRIESTHOOD<br>*Exodus–Leviticus* | The institutional office: hereditary, robed, and responsible for the machinery of atonement. Aaron also builds the golden calf when the people demand something to look at, and gives one of scripture's great administrative excuses — the gold went in the fire and out came this. The professional religious class that gives the people what they want and calls it worship. |

> THE STRUCTURAL POINT FOR DOMINION
>
> Every state religion in this literature has two offices in tension: the priest, who is appointed, hereditary and salaried, and the prophet, who is called, unlicensed and unpaid. The priest maintains the system; the prophet indicts it. When Dominion folded the second office into the first, it did not abolish prophecy — it made prophecy an employment category, which is a far more elegant solution.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

# THE MEN OF THE NEW TESTAMENT

*Failure, on the record, in the founding documents*

Note the pattern across all of these: the men closest to the centre are shown getting it wrong repeatedly, and the record was kept by the movement they went on to lead. An institution that publishes its founders' failures is doing something structurally different from one that publishes its founders' credentials.

| | |
|---|---|
| PETER<br>*all four gospels · Acts* | Impulsive, wrong out loud, and appointed anyway. He tries to talk the plan out of happening, swings a sword in a garden, denies knowing him three times to a servant girl, and is reinstated over breakfast with a question asked three times. Later he has to be argued into accepting outsiders and is publicly rebuked by Paul for backsliding on it. Authority that survives documented failure. |
| PAUL<br>*Acts · the letters* | A trained religious enforcer who persecuted the movement before joining it, and who never stops sounding like a man arguing. He is imprisoned repeatedly, defends himself in court, writes the line that everyone in the movement is one — no slave or free, no male or female — and also writes the lines used to keep women silent. Both are his. The most quoted and least read man in the book. |
| JUDAS<br>*the gospels* | Held the common purse and sold the location for a fixed price. He is the only one of the twelve given a motive, and it is money — although one gospel implies disillusionment. He returns the silver and is refused. The insider informant. Note that he was trusted with the funds, and that the authorities needed a man on the inside at all. |
| PILATE<br>*the gospels* | A governor who finds no case, says so, and signs the order anyway to keep the peace. He washes his hands in public — a gesture of documented non-responsibility — and the execution proceeds on his authority regardless. The administrator who disagrees and complies. Your most useful man for writing a functioning bureaucracy of harm. |
| JOHN THE BAPTIST<br>*the gospels* | Lives outside the city, refuses the priestly career he was born into, calls the religious establishment a nest of snakes to their faces, and is executed for criticising a ruler's marriage — at a party, as a favour, on a platter. From prison he sends a message asking whether he had been right about any of it. The unlicensed preacher, killed for a personal remark rather than a political one. |

WHICH OF THESE MEN IS JUDAH, AND WHICH IS DORIAN *write here*

# III

PART THREE · †

# JESUS, KINGDOM AND POWER

†

*Your novel is named after a line from his prayer. This is the part where you find out what he meant by it, and what the Empire has decided he meant.*


i · What He Meant by Kingdom 115

ii · Authority, Bodies, Women, Money 116

iii · The Lord's Prayer, Clause by Clause 117

# WHAT HE MEANT BY KINGDOM

Start with the word itself, because everything turns on it. He used a political term — *kingdom*, the same word used for the empire that occupied his country — and he used it constantly, more than any other phrase. He was not inventing a private spiritual category. He was making a claim about who actually governs, in a province where saying that got people crucified in rows along the roads.

But the content he poured into that political word is the opposite of what the word normally carries. His kingdom is described as small, hidden, and growing without permission: a seed, yeast in dough, treasure buried in a field. It belongs, he says, to the poor, the grieving, the pushed-around. Entry is granted to children, foreigners, tax collectors and the visibly disreputable, and it is described as extremely difficult for the rich — the one demographic every state religion is funded by.

Its politics are inverted on purpose. When his followers argue about rank he tells them the rulers of the nations lord it over people and it will not be like that among them; whoever wants to be first goes last. He washes their feet, which is slave work, and tells them to do the same. He refuses a crown when it is offered, evades arrest until he chooses not to, and enters the capital on a donkey in what is plainly a staged parody of a triumphal procession.

And it arrives now. Not later, not only after death — he says it is already among them, and he tells people to pray for it to come *on earth*. That single preposition is the most politically inconvenient word in the prayer your novel is named after, because a kingdom coming on earth has territory, and territory is already occupied.

> *"The rulers of the nations lord it over them. It shall not be so among you."*
>
> MATTHEW 20.25–26

> WHAT DOMINION DOES WITH IT
>
> Relocates the kingdom. It becomes either an interior condition of the obedient heart or a reward after death — anywhere but here, and above all not a claim on present territory. Then, having emptied the word, the Empire takes it for itself: Dominion *is* the kingdom come, which makes resisting the state ident ical to resisting God. That is the whole engine of your novel, stated in one move.

WHAT THIS GIVES TKC

Your title, weaponised in both directions. Every character who prays *thy kingdom come* is either asking for Dominion's permanence or for its replacement, and they may not know which. That ambiguity is worth a scene where the same line is said twice by two people.

WHAT DOES DOMINION TEACH THE KINGDOM IS *write here*

# FOUR THINGS HE KEPT DOING

*Authority · bodies · women · money*

| | |
|---|---|
| AUTHORITY | He teaches without citing a licence, which is what most enrages the professionals — officials keep demanding to know who authorised him. He breaks sabbath rules in public and argues the law back at the men who wrote the rulings, calls the establishment whitewashed tombs and blind guides, and overturns the temple's currency tables in the busiest week of the year.<br>**For TKC:** unlicensed authority is the crime Dominion cannot forgive, because it is the only crime that threatens the licensing system itself. |
| BODIES | He touches the people the purity system calls contagious: skin disease, corpses, a woman permanently unclean who touches him first without asking. The flow always runs the wrong way — he does not become unclean, they become well — which dismantles the logic of ritual contamination without once denouncing it.<br>**For TKC:** the woman who takes what she needs without permission and is commended for it. A theology of contact, against a state built on separation. |
| WOMEN | He lets a woman sit in the student's position and defends her for it. He accepts funding from women by name, debates theology with a foreign woman who wins the exchange, and is anointed by a woman in a room of men who call it a waste. No text records him instructing a woman to be silent.<br>**For TKC:** the gap between his practice and the Ministry's rules is documented in the Ministry's own book. That gap is a weapon. |
| MONEY | He talks about money more than almost anything else, never favourably. A camel through a needle's eye. A rich man told to liquidate. Debt forgiveness built into the prayer. His first public sermon announces a year of release — debts cancelled, captives freed — and the room turns on him.<br>**For TKC:** the most suppressed material in Dominion's scripture is economic, not sexual. Follow the money and you will find the censorship. |

QUESTIONS FOR THE NOVEL *write here*

# THY KINGDOM COME

*The prayer your novel is named after, clause by clause · Matthew 6 · Luke 11*

Short, corporate — every pronoun plural, no *I* anywhere — and almost every clause requests something a government normally controls.

| | |
|---|---|
| *Our Father in heaven* | A shared parent, which makes everyone praying it siblings — and makes rank inside the family a fiction. *In heaven* locates the authority somewhere no earthly office can occupy. Dominion prefers this clause said upward, never sideways. |
| *hallowed be thy name* | One name is set apart, which means every other name — imperial, dynastic, ministerial — is not. A sentence about whose name may be treated as holy is a sentence about idolatry. Ask what Dominion has carved above its doors. |
| *thy kingdom come* | A request for a change of government. Not for entry into a kingdom, not for comfort within one — for its *arrival*, which presumes it is not yet here. Anyone praying this is, by grammar, describing the present order as insufficient. This is your title and your novel's central problem. |
| *on earth as in heaven* | The clause that cannot be spiritualised. It specifies territory. Whatever this kingdom is, it is meant to be visible in the same place taxes are collected and soldiers are stationed. The five most dangerous words in the Empire's liturgy. |
| *our daily bread* | Enough for today, asked for together, in a world of grain stores and rationing. It is a request for subsistence rather than surplus — and for *ours*, not mine. A prayer that assumes the bread is currently held by someone else. |
| *forgive us our debts,<br>as we forgive our debtors* | The word is financial, and the two halves are locked together — the request is conditional on your own accounts. The only reciprocal clause in the prayer, and it is about release. Which is why most institutions render it *trespasses*. |
| *lead us not into trial,<br>but deliver us from evil* | A plea to be spared the test rather than to pass it heroically — an admission that people break, and that wanting to be spared is legitimate. A state that glorifies martyrdom needs this clause muted. |

> DOMINION'S VERSION
>
> Decide now, before you write another chapter: which clauses does the Empire recite daily, which has it re-translated, and which has it dropped? A prayer with a missing line is the quietest possible piece of evidence — and every character has it memorised.

DOMINION'S OFFICIAL TEXT — WHAT IS CUT, WHAT IS ADDED *write here*

REFERENCE UNIT · ◈

# FOUR ACCOUNTS, ONE SUBJECT

*There is no single Gospel. There are four, they were written for different communities decades apart, and they disagree about the order of events, the wording of the sayings, the day of the death, and what happened at the tomb. This unit is the tool for holding all four at once without flattening them into one.*

### WHY A GRID AND NOT A HARMONY

A harmony stitches the four into one story and quietly deletes the differences. The differences are the most useful material in the New Testament for a writer: they show four groups deciding what mattered, and what they were willing to change to say it.

### HOW TO WORK IT

G02 and G03 are pure reference — keep them open beside the text. G04 is a worksheet you run on any episode. G05 is the list of real disagreements. G06 closes the unit.

### WHAT THIS UNIT WILL NOT DO

It will not tell you which account is right, whether the differences are contradictions or perspectives, or what any of it obliges you to believe. Every dating and every source theory below is marked as an argued position. Where the field is genuinely split, the split is printed. **[R]**

### WHICH GOSPEL I WAS ACTUALLY TAUGHT FROM — AND WHETHER I WAS TOLD THERE WERE FOUR

SOURCE MARGIN

MATT · MARK LUKE · JOHN

NA28 · UBS5

SANDERS, THE HIST. FIGURE OF JESUS

EHRMAN, THE NEW TESTAMENT

TKC: PART III

MARK 1.1

MATT 1.1

LUKE 1 .1–4

JOHN 1.1 · 20.31

PAPIAS (2ND C. ATTRIB.)

TKC: PART III

# THE RECORD ON EACH

All four are formally anonymous; the names were attached by later tradition, generally in the second century. Dates below are the mainstream ranges, and every one of them is argued. **[R]**

| GOSPEL | USUAL DATE | WHAT IT IS DOING |
|---|---|---|
| **Mark** | c. 65–75 | Shortest, fastest, roughest Greek. No birth story, no genealogy. Disciples consistently fail to understand; the identity of Jesus is kept quiet and revealed at the cross by a Roman soldier. Written near or after a catastrophic war. **[C]** |
| **Matthew** | c. 80–90 | Organizes teaching into five large blocks and repeatedly says an event happened "to fulfill" scripture. Genealogy from Abraham. Most interested of the four in the law, the assembly's internal discipline, and judgment. **[C]** |
| **Luke** | c. 80–95 | Opens with a formal dedication claiming orderly research. Genealogy back to Adam. Heaviest emphasis of the four on the poor, on reversal of wealth and status, and on women in the narrative; continues into Acts as a two-volume work. **[C]** |
| **John** | c. 90–110 | A different book. No parables of the familiar kind, no exorcisms, long first-person discourses, seven signs, and an opening that starts before creation rather than at a birth. States its own purpose openly at the end. **[C]** |

| FEATURE | WHERE IT IS — AND WHERE IT IS NOT |
|---|---|
| Birth narrative | Matthew and Luke only, and they share almost no details — different genealogies, different visitors, different itinerary afterward. Mark and John have none. **[C]** |
| Parables | Dense in the first three. The best-known ones — the good Samaritan, the prodigal son — are in Luke alone. None of that kind in John. **[C]** |
| Exorcisms | Frequent in the first three and central to Mark. Entirely absent from John. **[C]** |
| Length of ministry | The first three can be read as roughly a year with one journey to Jerusalem. John has multiple Passovers and repeated visits, which is where the traditional three years comes from. **[R]** |
| Ending | Mark's earliest manuscripts end with frightened women and no appearance; the familiar longer ending is absent from the oldest copies and is printed in modern Bibles with a note. This is a textual fact, not a theory. **[C]** |

WHICH OF THE FOUR VOICES IS CLOSEST TO HOW MY WORLD TELLS ITS OWN FOUNDING STORY

# THE OVERLAP PROBLEM

MARK 8 .22–26

MARK 14 .51–52

MATT 2

LUKE 1 .46–55

JOHN 11

GOODACRE, THE CASE AGAINST Q

TKC: PART III

The first three gospels run parallel closely enough to be printed in columns — same episodes, same order, sometimes identical Greek for long stretches. That is not what independent memory produces. Some literary relationship is certain; which one is the oldest live argument in the field. **[R]**

| PROPOSAL | WHAT IT CLAIMS, AND ITS WEAK POINT |
|---|---|
| Mark first, plus a sayings source | The majority position: Matthew and Luke each used Mark, plus a lost collection of sayings, plus their own separate material. Weak point — the sayings source has never been found and is reconstructed from the very texts it is meant to explain. **[R]** |
| Mark first, Luke used Matthew | A serious minority position that needs no lost document: Luke read Mark and Matthew both. Weak point — it has to explain why Luke would break up Matthew's sermons and relocate the pieces. **[R]** |
| Matthew first | The traditional order, still defended: Mark is an abridgement. Weak point — it has to explain why an abridger would add crude detail, awkward Greek, and unflattering portraits of the disciples. **[R]** |
| John and the other three | Whether John knew the first three, knew a tradition behind them, or wrote independently is separately disputed. Its differences are too large to be editorial trimming. **[R]** |

| ONLY IN | MATERIAL YOU WILL FIND NOWHERE ELSE |
|---|---|
| Mark | A healing that takes two attempts, a young man who flees naked at the arrest, and the abrupt ending at the empty tomb. The details later writers smoothed away. **[C]** |
| Matthew | The visitors from the east, the massacre of the children, the flight to Egypt, the guard at the tomb, and the sheep-and-goats judgment scene. **[C]** |
| Luke | The shepherds, Mary's song of reversal, the good Samaritan, the prodigal son, the rich man and Lazarus, and the road to Emmaus. The material most often quoted about poverty and mercy is largely his. **[C]** |
| John | The wedding at Cana, the night conversation with Nicodemus, the Samaritan woman at the well, the raising of Lazarus, the foot-washing, and the long farewell discourse. **[C]** |

### THE FINDING THAT MATTERS FOR TKC

Whatever the order, later writers demonstrably edited earlier ones: softening, reordering, adding a birth, adding an ending. Scripture, inside the canon, is visibly revised scripture. An empire that claims a fixed and unedited text is claiming something the documents themselves contradict — and that is a device, not a polemic. **[P]**

WHO EDITED THE FOUNDING ACCOUNT IN MY WORLD — AND WHAT THEY SOFTENED

METHOD

GRID WORKSHEET

SEE PART I METHOD PAGES

# RUN ANY EPISODE THROUGH IT

Pick an episode that appears in more than one gospel and fill the columns from the text itself, not from memory. Suggested starters: the temple action, the anointing, the trial before Pilate, the words from the cross, the empty tomb.

EPISODE

TRANSLATION USED

| GOSPEL | REFERENCE · WHAT HAPPENS | WHAT IS ADDED, MISSING, OR CHANGED |
|---|---|---|
| Mark | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| Matthew | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| Luke | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| John | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

THE DIFFERENCE THAT ACTUALLY CHANGES THE MEANING — AND WHOSE INTEREST IT SERVES

WHICH VERSION MY WORLD WOULD CANONIZE, AND WHICH IT WOULD SUPPRESS

# WHERE THEY DO NOT MATCH

JOHN 2 .13–22

JOHN 19 .14–31

MATT 1 · LUKE 3

MATT 5 · LUKE 6

MATT 6 · LUKE 11

MARK 16 · JOHN 20

TKC: WOMEN III

These are differences in the text, not interpretations of it. Whether they are contradictions or complementary perspectives is a theological judgment this companion leaves to you; that they are differences is not in dispute. **[C]**

| POINT | THE DIVERGENCE |
|---|---|
| THE TEMPLE ACTION | In the first three it happens in the final week and functions as the trigger for the arrest. In John it is placed at the very beginning of the ministry. Same event, opposite structural role. **[C]** |
| THE DAY OF DEATH | The first three present the last meal as a Passover meal. John places the crucifixion before the Passover meal is eaten, so that the death coincides with the slaughter of the lambs. The theological point and the chronology cannot both be dropped. **[C]** |
| THE GENEALOGIES | Matthew and Luke give different lines with different names between David and Joseph, and run in different directions. Proposed reconciliations exist and none commands agreement. **[R]** |
| AFTER THE BIRTH | Matthew has a flight to Egypt to escape a massacre. Luke has a calm presentation at the temple and a return to Nazareth. The two itineraries are hard to run at once. **[C]** |
| THE BEATITUDES | Matthew sets them on a mountain and blesses the poor in spirit; Luke sets them on level ground, blesses the poor, and adds matching curses on the rich. One is interior, one is economic. Choosing between them is a choice about the whole message. **[C]** |
| THE PRAYER | Luke's version is shorter than Matthew's, and the familiar closing line about kingdom and power is absent from the oldest manuscripts of both. The prayer most recited in the world is a composite. **[C]** |
| WORDS FROM THE CROSS | Mark and Matthew record a cry of abandonment. Luke records forgiveness and commendation. John records the care of his mother and a declared completion. No two of the four give the same last words. **[C]** |
| AT THE TOMB | The number of women, the number of figures at the tomb, whether the stone is already moved, who is told, where the appearances happen — Galilee or Jerusalem — and whether anyone speaks all differ across the four. Women are the first witnesses in every one. **[C]** |

### THE ONE DETAIL THEY ALL KEEP

Four accounts that agree on almost no logistical detail all put women at the tomb first, in a legal culture where their testimony carried little weight. Whatever else it is, it is not the detail an inventing committee would have chosen. Note it, and note that noting it is an argument about plausibility, not a proof. **[R]**

WHOSE TESTIMONY MY WORLD REFUSES TO COUNT — AND WHAT THEY SAW ANYWAY

WRITING

UNIT CLOSE

QUEUE: G0

# WHAT I TAKE OUT OF THE GRID

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN TWO ACCOUNTS THAT I AM PUTTING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT

WHICH OF DOMINION'S FOUR ACCOUNTS THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES, AND WHY THAT ONE

WHAT I STILL NEED TO CHECK — CARRY TO THE RESEARCH LIST

PROOFING GATE

*log only — nothing is closed here*

Unit G0 is built at five numbered pages plus the opening, with no reserved plate and no content preparation required. Source theories and dates are carried as **Argued**; textual facts about manuscript endings are carried as **Confirmed**. Outstanding for the gate: full citations with edition and year.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

# IV

PART FOUR · ▣

# EMPIRE AND INTERPRETATION

*No empire in this literature ever had to change a word of scripture. It only ever had to decide which words were read aloud, and to whom, and how often.*


i · Empires of the Bible 119

ii · Who Gets to Say What It Means 120

iii · Passages Dominion Would Weaponise 121

iv · Passages Dominion Would Suppress 122

# EMPIRES OF THE BIBLE

*Five occupations, and what each one wanted from the people it held*

Almost the entire Bible is written by people living under somebody else's government. Read the empires as a menu of methods, because Dominion will be using some combination of them.

| | |
|---|---|
| EGYPT<br>*forced labour* | Wants bodies. It extracts work, controls reproduction by decree, and manages unrest by increasing quotas rather than negotiating. Its method is exhaustion — people too tired to organise. The model for a state that governs through the working day. |
| ASSYRIA<br>*terror & deportation* | Wants submission, and advertises the cost of refusing it. Its speciality is population transfer — break a people apart, resettle them among strangers, and the identity dissolves within two generations. It sends officials to shout propaganda at city walls in the local language. Terror as published policy. |
| BABYLON<br>*elite capture* | Wants the top of the society, not the bottom. It deports the educated, trains them in its own bureaucracy, renames them, and hands them careers — which is far cheaper than terror and produces administrators who cannot tell whether they were saved or absorbed. The Daniel problem. Your Ministry runs this scheme. |
| PERSIA<br>*sponsored religion* | Wants order, and finds tolerance cheaper than suppression. It funds the rebuilding of the temple, licenses local worship, and issues irrevocable decrees — so its violence is procedural rather than passionate. It also runs a court where women are gathered by search and a queen is removed by legislation. An empire whose scripture-friendliness is a governing technique. |
| ROME<br>*collaboration & spectacle* | Wants taxes and quiet, and governs through local clients who do the unpopular work — a client king, a compliant priesthood, a governor who signs orders he disagrees with. Its executions are public, slow, and positioned on roads. It calls its emperor divine and its violence peace. The full model: religion, bureaucracy and theatre in one system. |

> THE COMPOSITE FOR DOMINION
>
> Dominion is Babylon's elite capture plus Persia's licensed religion plus Rome's client collaboration — the three methods that require the fewest soldiers. Terror is expensive; a career path is not.

WHICH METHODS DOES DOMINION USE, AND ON WHOM *write here*

# WHO GETS TO SAY WHAT IT MEANS

Authority over a text is never a single thing. It is a set of separate powers, usually held by different people, and a religious state becomes total when one institution collects all of them. Work out which of the seven below Dominion holds, because the ones it does not hold are where your plot lives.

| | |
|---|---|
| THE CANON | Which books count. Usually settled long ago, and therefore invisible. |
| THE TRANSLATION | Which words. The quietest and most powerful lever there is. |
| THE LECTIONARY | Which passages are read aloud, on which days, in which order. Most people's entire scripture is whatever the calendar allows. |
| THE COMMENTARY | What the passage is taken to mean. Handed down as though it were the text. |
| THE PULPIT | Who may stand up and speak. The licence, and the withdrawal of it. |
| THE COPY | Who owns a physical book, and which edition. Access is doctrine. |
| LITERACY | Who can read it unaided. The oldest control of all, and the cheapest. |

THE HISTORICAL PATTERN

Every movement that broke a religious monopoly did it by attacking one of these seven — usually translation or literacy, occasionally the copy. Reform arrives as a printing problem before it arrives as a theological one.

FOR YOUR WORLDBUILDING

Decide who in Dominion may own an unabridged copy, who may read aloud, what the provincial edition omits, and what happens to a household caught with an older translation.

WHICH OF THE SEVEN DOES DOMINION NOT CONTROL *write here*

# PASSAGES DOMINION WOULD WEAPONISE

*The state's working toolkit — every one of them genuinely in the book*

| PASSAGE | WHAT IT IS MADE TO DO — AND WHAT IT ACTUALLY SAYS |
|---|---|
| *Genesis 3.16* | Made into a constitution for the household. Actually a description of consequence in a poem about exile — a curse, not a command, and read as prescription only by choosing to. |
| *Romans 13.1* | Made into total obedience to the state. Written by a man repeatedly imprisoned by that state, in a collection full of prophets defying kings and apostles refusing magistrates. |
| *Ephesians 5.22* | Made into household law. Sits directly under an instruction for everyone to submit to one another, and above a passage three times longer demanding self-sacrifice from husbands. |
| *1 Timothy 2.11–12* | Made into a permanent ban on women teaching. One sentence, in the most disputed letter in the collection, contradicted by named women teaching elsewhere in the same book. |
| *Deuteronomy 28* | Made into a national scoreboard: prosperity proves virtue, disaster proves someone's sin. The engine of every purge, and the thing Job exists to contradict. |
| *Joshua 7* | Made into the case for collective punishment — one household's disobedience endangers the nation, therefore surveillance is a mercy and informing is a duty. |
| *Numbers 16* | Made into the standing sermon against dissent: the ground opens under people who question ordained leadership. Preached annually. Zelophehad's daughters, never. |
| *Judges 21.25* | Made into the founding slogan: without a divinely ordered ruler, everyone does as they please and women pay for it. Order as the alternative to atrocity. |
| *2 Samuel 7* | Made into the eternal dynasty clause — the legal basis of the throne itself, and the reason the founder's crimes are a matter for private repentance rather than public account. |

WHICH IS CARVED ON A DOMINION WALL *write here*

# PASSAGES DOMINION WOULD SUPPRESS

| PASSAGE | WHY IT CANNOT BE READ ALOUD |
|---|---|
| *Leviticus 25* | Jubilee. Debts cancelled and land returned every fifty years, by law — the most economically dangerous chapter in scripture. |
| *Deuteronomy 17* | Limits on the king: no hoarding of horses, wives or silver. A single verse that indicts the Emperor's household by inventory. |
| *Numbers 27* | Five women petition to change inheritance law and God rules in their favour. A precedent for successful female legal challenge, in the Torah. |
| *1 Samuel 8* | God's own warning about what a monarchy will take from you, itemised: your sons, your daughters, a tenth of everything. Printed, and never preached. |
| *1 Kings 21* | Naboth's vineyard. The state kills a man for his land using correct legal procedure, and a prophet names it as murder to the king's face. |
| *2 Kings 22* | A woman authenticates scripture for the king and the whole reform proceeds on her ruling. Not in the syllabus at any level. |
| *Amos 5* | God refuses the festivals and calls the worship music noise while injustice continues. Unusable in any state liturgy. |
| *Ezekiel 18 · 34* | Guilt is not inherited — which dismantles collective punishment — and the shepherds of the people are indicted for feeding themselves. |
| *Luke 1.46–55* | The Magnificat. Thrones emptied, the rich sent away — sung by a teenage girl, in the past tense. |
| *Luke 4.16–30* | His first sermon announces release for captives and a year of debt relief. The congregation tries to throw him off a cliff. |
| *Matthew 23* | A whole chapter denouncing religious leaders by title. |
| *Revelation 18* | An empire falls and the merchants weep because their trade is ruined. Read as prophecy of the far future, never as description. |

WHICH ONE DOES SHE FIND FIRST *write here*

# WHERE ALL OF THIS CAME FROM

SOURCE MARGIN

BACK MATTER

KEYED TO ALL PARTS

SEE ALSO PROOFING GATES

*Every page of this companion carries a narrow source margin on its outer edge, printed in compressed form — author, short title. Those compressed forms are keyed to the full citations on the next two pages. Nothing in the margins is a citation; it is a pointer to one.*

| | |
|---|---|
| [C] CONFIRMED | The text says this, or the manuscript evidence shows it. You can check it in any study Bible with a critical apparatus. |
| [R] ARGUED | Responsible scholars disagree. The companion prints the dispute and the strongest case on each side, and does not print a verdict. |
| [P] POSSIBLE | A TKC construction — something about Dominion, the Sanctum, or the manuscript, not a claim about scripture. Test it against the manuscript before use. |
| [CANON] | A Possible that has been ruled on and promoted. Fixed for the manuscript until you rule otherwise. |

### ON THE SECONDARY LITERATURE

The works below are standard reference points, not an endorsement of any one position. Where two of them disagree — and several do, sharply — the companion prints the disagreement rather than picking. Several are technical commentaries that assume Hebrew or Greek; you do not need them to use this book. They are listed so that any claim in it can be traced.

### TRANSLATIONS I AM WORKING FROM — RECORD THEM ONCE, HERE

| TRANSLATION | EDITION / PRINTING | USED FOR |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
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| | | |
| | | |

The companion deliberately does not standardize on one English translation. Where a rendering is doing interpretive work, the page says so and tells you to compare.

# TEXTS AND COMMENTARIES

## PRIMARY TEXT EDITIONS

| | |
|---|---|
| MT | *Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia.* Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft. The standard printed Masoretic text; cite the printing you use. |
| LXX | Rahlfs–Hanhart, *Septuaginta.* Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft. The Greek translation of the Hebrew scriptures; consulted where it differs from MT. |
| DSS | Dead Sea Scroll manuscripts cited by siglum, e.g. 4QDeut. Consulted only where a scroll reading is materially different. |

## LEXICA

| | |
|---|---|
| BDB | Brown, Driver and Briggs, *A Hebrew and English Lexicon of the Old Testament.* Oxford: Clarendon, 1906. Old, free, and still the one most readers can actually get to. |
| HALOT | Koehler and Baumgartner, *The Hebrew and Aramaic Lexicon of the Old Testament.* Leiden: Brill. The current scholarly standard; use it over BDB where the two conflict. |

## SECONDARY LITERATURE CITED IN THE MARGINS

| | |
|---|---|
| MILGROM | Jacob Milgrom, *Leviticus.* Anchor Bible 3, 3A, 3B. New York: Doubleday, 1991–2001. Three volumes; the standard technical commentary. Margin notes name the volume by chapter range. |
| KLAWANS | Jonathan Klawans, *Impurity and Sin in Ancient Judaism.* Oxford University Press, 2000. The distinction between ritual and moral impurity that Dossier III leans on. |
| DOUGLAS | Mary Douglas, *Purity and Danger.* London: Routledge, 1966. Structural reading of the dietary law; she revised her own position later, and the companion says so. |
| OLYAN | Saul M. Olyan, *Disability in the Hebrew Bible.* Cambridge University Press, 2008. Behind the blemish material on LV11. |
| BERGSMA | John Sietze Bergsma, *The Jubilee from Leviticus to Qumran.* Leiden: Brill, 2007. The afterlife of Leviticus 25. |
| WEINFELD | Moshe Weinfeld, *Deuteronomy 1–11.* Anchor Bible 5. Doubleday, 1991; and *Deuteronomy and the Deuteronomic School.* Oxford: Clarendon, 1972. The treaty-form comparison in Dossier IV. |
| LEVINSON | Bernard M. Levinson, *Deuteronomy and the Hermeneutics of Legal Innovation.* Oxford University Press, 1997. How Deuteronomy rewrites earlier law while claiming to preserve it. |
| GOLDENBERG | David M. Goldenberg, *The Curse of Ham: Race and Slavery in Early Judaism, Christianity, and Islam.* Princeton University Press, 2003. The reception history behind Genesis 9. |

## GREEK NEW TESTAMENT

| | |
|---|---|
| NA28 | *Novum Testamentum Graece,* 28th revised edition. Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2012. Where the companion says a reading is absent from the oldest manuscripts, this is the apparatus it means. |
| UBS5 | *The Greek New Testament,* 5th revised edition. United Bible Societies, 2014. Same text as NA28 with a reader-facing apparatus. |

## SECONDARY LITERATURE — PARTS III AND IV

| | |
|---|---|
| SANDERS | E. P. Sanders, *The Historical Figure of Jesus.* London: Penguin, 1993. A restrained account of what the sources can and cannot establish. |
| EHRMAN | Bart D. Ehrman, *The New Testament: A Historical Introduction to the Early Christian Writings.* Oxford University Press. Revised frequently — record the edition you own, since page references move. |
| GOODACRE | Mark Goodacre, *The Case Against Q.* Harrisburg: Trinity Press International, 2002. The minority source proposal set out on G03; cited so the majority view is not the only one on the page. |

## COMPARATIVE ANCIENT TEXTS

| | |
|---|---|
| COS | William W. Hallo and K. Lawson Younger, eds., *The Context of Scripture.* Leiden: Brill, 1997–2002. Source for the flood parallels, the Mesha inscription, and the law-code comparisons. |
| SAA 2 | Simo Parpola and Kazuko Watanabe, *Neo-Assyrian Treaties and Loyalty Oaths.* Helsinki University Press, 1988. The succession-treaty curse list compared with Deuteronomy 28. |
| GILGAMESH | Cited from COS or from a standard translation of your choosing. Any recent scholarly edition will serve for the comparison the companion actually makes. |

## EDITIONS I ACTUALLY OWN — FILL THIS IN AS YOU ACQUIRE THEM

| WORK | EDITION AND YEAR | CHECKED |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
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### WHAT IS STILL OUTSTANDING

Page-level references. This list identifies the works behind each claim; it does not yet give a page for every one. Adding those is a proofing task, and every dossier's proofing gate carries it as outstanding until it is done.

SOURCE MARGIN
PART III
PART IV
GOSPEL GRID G0
SEE ALSO PROOFING GATES